Supplement: signals, interfaces and worked-example data

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This supplement accompanies the manuscript. S1 and S2 explain the sources and selection. S3 to S5 specify the signals, records and interfaces. S6 supplies the hypothetical investigations and their arithmetic; S7 and S8 give the proposed evaluations. S9 extends the comparison with prior work, and S10 replays two FTC complaints on synthetic records. The 19 CSV files use UTF-8 encoding and stable mechanism, source and signal identifiers. Citation labels match the package's BibLaTeX references.

S1. Sources and comparisons

Source notes identify the version, supporting passages, publication status and supported claim for each of the 127 cited works. The requirements matrix compares 50 sources against C1 to C3. It codes two parts of C1 and C2 and three of C3: an outcome linked to its decision, and late, unobservable and false reports kept apart (C1); query coverage and learned time (C2); typed separation of observations, inferences and memory, a human principal before reuse, and links from records an agent output informed back to that output (C3). E means explicit support, P partial or adjacent support, and a dot means the cited material does not establish the requirement. The `payment_setting` column records yes for a payment or payment-fraud setting, P for a setting partly in payments or adjacent to payment fraud, and no otherwise. It marks two cyber threat intelligence sources, STIX 2.1 and Hettema's belief-revision paper, as cyber; other security and threat-intelligence sources are coded no. The source notes link to the matrix by citation key, and their inspection dates are in UTC.

Stage coverage supplies the source-level codes behind Table S1.1. Source notes record bibliographic and access issues separately from claims about a method.

Study populations and denominators constrain the comparisons. Sharma's balanced synthetic sample contains 60 cases drawn from transactions its classifier scored between 0.2 and 0.8: thresholding the classifier at 0.5 decides 43 correctly and the agent 39. Six of the agent's eight overrides replace a correct decision with an error. Fatima's verification rates concern genuine participants under the study's completion and exclusion rules; they do not measure fraud detection. Doerfler's 47.8 percent same-session success rate concerns challenged sign-ins. Its 97.3 percent rate of access within one week counts users, not sign-ins. Doerfler's Section 5.3 and Table 7 caption take users who failed a challenge as the denominator; its introduction takes users who saw a challenge. Its abstract treats the complement of the first rate as legitimate users failing to sign in, but its results note that hijacking activity depresses per-session success. Subtracting the first rate from 100 percent therefore does not give a clean legitimate-user failure rate. Neither Fatima's nor Doerfler's aggregate rate establishes whether an individual event was decided correctly.

FTC complaints describe allegations, and the stipulated orders do not establish them on their merits. Vendor publications support attributed descriptions of interfaces or observations, not independent evidence of industry-wide effectiveness.

Table S1.1. Stages described in the cited research. E means explicitly described; P means partial coverage or a different scope; a dot means not established by the cited material. Each family receives the strongest source-level code in S1, so one row may combine several systems. L1: signal sources; L2: ingestion and stores; L3: entities, correlation and knowledge; L4: investigation; L5: outputs; L6: feedback; L7: governance; L8: learning and correction.

Research family and inspected examples	L1	L2	L3	L4	L5	L6	L7	L8	Payment domain
Industrial payment and risk systems: TitAnt, GEM	P	E	P	.	P	P	.	P	yes
Stripe's engineering publications, 2019 to 2025	P	E	P	P	P	E	.	P	yes
Threat-intelligence and security-operations architectures: reference models, intelligence lifecycle and agent benchmarks	P	P	E	E	E	P	E	E	no
Preprints on agents making fraud decisions: SR-Fraud and Sharma's auditable agent	P	P	P	E	P	E	P	E	yes

S2. Product scope and mechanism selection

Product scope contains 88 public product and feature entries, read on 27 September 2026: 53 catalog items, twenty items from the Q3 2026 public roadmap (seventeen appear in a cached copy of that roadmap; the other three are confirmed as shipped in Stripe's changelog), ten separately documented capabilities and five careers-page footer items. These entries define the scope for candidate selection, not a complete or current product catalog. Each row lists candidate mechanism IDs, not validated coverage or retained signal mappings; a dot means none is listed. The entries list 85 of the 99 candidates; the other 14 appear only in the allocation table. Six retained mechanisms are not listed against any product entry: ID-14 (account farming and aged-account preparation for later abuse), PAY-04 (card testing through attacker-controlled merchant or connected accounts), MP-02 (payment-method cashing through a self-controlled merchant or connected account), MP-04 (merchant misrepresentation and transaction laundering behind a front), MP-07 (merchant-side dispute evasion) and BOT-04 (CAPTCHA and challenge defeat). S5 identifies the exact API schemas used for interface comparisons.

Products and business-reported records (manuscript Section 4.1). The platform's products may span onboarding, identity verification, payments, subscriptions, payouts, treasury and risk controls. Businesses may also report their customers' registrations, logins and payments. The specification identifies what investigators need from these records without assuming a provider already collects or links them.

A retained mechanism targets a documented capability, serves a plausible adversary goal and has supporting public evidence. Sources include research, incident reports, government and intergovernmental guidance, and platform documentation. Four public job postings for abuse, risk and machine-learning roles helped prioritize topics but do not establish incidents; the manuscript cites two (Section 3), and the allocation keys record the other two. The stated priority basis names a posting topic for 24 candidates. Twenty-three of them are among the 26 candidates allocated Tier 1; all 23 are mapped and carry 65 of the 163 links. The 24th, EC-06, is unmapped. Every mapped mechanism has support beyond postings in the mechanism-to-source links.

Mechanism allocation records all 99 candidates and their final dispositions. The signal map retains 61 mechanisms: 52 of the 53 dedicated candidates, all eight targeted candidates and the one adjacent-logged candidate, ID-18, insider access abuse by platform or partner staff. Of the other

38, nine are covered, four are record gaps, four are screened gaps and twenty are unreviewed, as the table below defines, and one reviewed candidate, PAY-12, has no signal mapping. PAY-12 concerns triangulation fraud: filling real customers' orders through another seller using stolen payment credentials. Its review record notes framework evidence only. The four record gaps are fake reviews (MP-08), e-skimming on merchant checkout pages (API-09), supply-chain compromise of commerce plugins and packages (API-10) and business stablecoin issuance abuse (MP-11). A second rater named a record each would need, and the inventory holds no such record (S3). Allocation keys decode the source abbreviations. The `Class` code, also the prefix before each key's colon, gives the source type: a for law-enforcement announcements and vendor or incident reports, including EchoLeak (a:ECHO), which is cited by its arXiv identifier; b for research papers; b* for other arXiv preprints; c for government and intergovernmental publications and the MITRE fraud framework; d for Stripe's documentation, roadmap, blog and public repositories; and e for Stripe's job postings. All four b keys name a peer-reviewed venue. In the `Verification` column, V marks a key recorded as verified, and S marks a key that rests on a summarizing retrieval whose exact passage was not retained, as the `d:S` row states. The allocation file repeats S as a suffix on its evidence keys, as in `a:SSN (S)`. Priority labels explain selection emphasis; they do not measure evidence quality.

Reading the selection records The allocation file's `disposition` field states the final selection decision. Signal coverage is recorded separately in S3; a reviewed candidate need not have a signal mapping.

Disposition	Meaning
dedicated	Reviewed as a distinct mechanism
targeted	Received a focused review of its implications for the design
covered	Judged covered by existing records, not retained as a separate mapped mechanism
record gap	Reviewed and first judged covered; a second-rater check found that no record in the inventory covers it
screened gap	Screened without identified supporting evidence and logged as a low-priority gap
unreviewed	Not reviewed; all twenty such candidates have low priority
adjacent logged	Recorded as adjacent to the core mechanisms; the one such candidate is retained in the signal map

`Priority (basis)` and `Impact (basis)` retain the selection judgments and their stated reasons. In a priority basis, `r:` introduces a topic named in a job posting, with the posting's key in parentheses where given, and `p:` introduces platform-documentation keys. A posting key such as `(EM)` is the allocation key `e:EM` without its class prefix; platform-documentation keys keep their `d:` prefix. Impact bases use no prefixes. `Scope` distinguishes core and adjacent mechanisms. `Parent` records a stated relationship to another mechanism; a dot means none is listed. `Evidence keys` are identifiers, not evidence grades. `Maturity` is the estimate, before review, of how developed the published research was; `after_review_maturity` pairs it with the later classification where both were supplied. `Evidence` is the confidence label used to allocate effort (verified, provisional or unresolved), not a certification of each source's claims. `Depth` is the initial allocation: Tier 1 for the deeper review, Tier 2 otherwise, or a logged gap when evidence was unresolved. `recorded_status` states each review's outcome.

Searches covered nine abuse paths, coded U1 to U9: API-key takeover (U1), identity provenance at onboarding (U2), document integrity, including identity and business documents (U3), account compromise (U4), payout redirection (U5), card testing (U6), abusive merchants (U7), mule and

pass-through funds (U8), and attacks on agents or operator assistants (U9). Only the entity-relationship notes cite these codes. Searches followed relevant publications, public guidance and references. This focused selection does not establish exhaustive coverage of abuse or related systems.

S2.1 Claim types

Research can propose an untested design, while documentation can directly establish an interface. Neither publication status nor the number of sources validates the integrated specification. No claim in either document rests on author experience.

Table S2.1. How to read the manuscript's claims. Claim type describes what a statement establishes. Source type and publication status describe where its support comes from.

Claim type	What it means
Fact	A description supported by evidence, including a public specification or an artifact this study produced; source and version are given where they matter
Peer-reviewed prior research	A finding reported in a peer-reviewed publication whose publication status was confirmed, applicable only to the setting and conditions it studied
Inference	A conclusion motivated by stated premises; the sources do not establish the conclusion directly
Design requirement	A property chosen for the proposed platform on the stated evidence and reasoning; it is not claimed as necessary for every platform or as observed in a deployment
Hypothesis	A proposition to test for the proposed platform, including every detection candidate in the manuscript
Proposed implementation	One possible way to satisfy a requirement
Empirically validated result	A measurement, valid for the proposition and setting actually tested; results for individual components do not validate this integrated design

S2.2 External coverage check

An external check compares the candidates with MITRE's Fight Fraud Framework (F3), version 1.2 [1]. Mechanism selection used version 1.1 (allocation key c:F3); version 1.2 adds 16 techniques and removes one. The F3 crosswalk maps each of its 138 techniques and sub-techniques to the candidate mechanisms that cover it, with a reason for each scope decision. Of the 105 within the product scope, a retained mechanism covers 35 fully and 49 in part. Of the other 21, fourteen are covered only by candidates outside the signal map. Two of the fourteen rest only on candidates judged covered by existing records, among them device fingerprint spoofing. Three rest only on candidates recorded as record gaps: the adversary-in-the-browser technique and two of its sub-techniques, which the candidates describe but no record in the inventory covers. Six rest only on unreviewed candidates, among them 3-D Secure bypass, and three rest on covered and unreviewed candidates together. None rests on a screened gap. Seven are covered by no candidate: DLL injection in the browser, compromise of point-of-sale systems, coercion, keylogging, abuse of accessibility features, theft from password managers and SEO poisoning. Scope and coverage are one reviewer's judgments, recorded for each row.

Figure S3.1. What each record class can establish. Counts refer to the 71 signals; the two output classes hold none.



S3. Signals, mappings and lineage

The signal inventory defines all 71 signals, with their families, classes, feature inputs, mechanism and source IDs, public counterparts, entities, uses and limits. Its `internal_representation_status` value, DR for every signal, marks a design requirement, not observed platform instrumentation. Mechanism-to-signal mappings contain 163 links: 154 design mappings motivated by evidence and nine marked as inferential. These links explain why a record is proposed; they do not establish a detector's effectiveness or make its fields uniquely necessary.

The outcome-channel requirements use SIG-70 and SIG-71 to record each payment-level or account-level control decision's effect on each outcome channel, SIG-27 to separate authentication results from reported liability status, and SIG-58 for dispute reasons and payout returns. SIG-70 also keeps manual-review dispositions. Each record retains its source, version and uncertainty.

The inventory contains 26 source observations (SO), two normalized observations (NO), 24 derived features (DF), two model or risk outputs (MO) and ten control outcomes (CO). Seven signals provide external knowledge (XK). The inventory therefore covers five of the seven record classes in manuscript Section 5.1, plus external knowledge. Analytical inferences and finished intelligence are later outputs, not input signals.

SIG-44, SIG-45 and SIG-46 apply across mechanisms. They record technique-catalog mappings, minimum observation provenance and the provenance of test records, respectively. The other 68 signals map to specific mechanisms. All 61 mapped mechanisms have at least one mapping motivated by evidence; S2 explains PAY-12's exclusion.

Table S3.1. The 71 signals by family. SO: source observation; NO: normalized observation; DF: derived feature; MO: model or risk output; CO: control outcome; XK: external knowledge. The final column counts partial public counterparts, cases where that comparison does not apply, and signals with no counterpart identified in the pinned schemas (manuscript Section 5.4). Token allowances permit another party to spend from a crypto wallet.

Family	Signals	Classes	Partial / n/a / none identified
Identity and onboarding	8	SO 3, DF 4, CO 1	3 / 4 / 1
Authentication, session and operator administration	10	SO 5, DF 4, CO 1	6 / 4 / 0
Credentials, API keys and request context	5	SO 3, DF 1, XK 1	2 / 2 / 1
Funds movement and payout destinations	11	SO 4, DF 5, CO 2	6 / 5 / 0
Payment attempts, authorization and payment controls	7	SO 2, DF 4, CO 1	3 / 4 / 0
End-customer lifecycle and entitlement	7	SO 2, DF 4, CO 1	3 / 4 / 0
Merchant storefront and business claims	2	DF 1, XK 1	0 / 2 / 0
Platform outputs and labels	4	SO 1, MO 2, CO 1	4 / 0 / 0
Agents, tools and approvals	8	SO 5, CO 3	4 / 0 / 4
Wallet signing and token allowances	2	SO 1, DF 1	0 / 1 / 1
External threat knowledge	5	XK 5	0 / 5 / 0
Provenance classes	2	NO 2	1 / 1 / 0

Second-rater check of the links (10 November 2026). The links were made without a written linking rule. For this check a rule was written afterward (packet): link a mechanism to a signal when an investigator of that mechanism would need the record, and a listed source describes behaviour the record would capture. A rater that took no part in the mapping, OpenAI's GPT-6 in a session without memory, project files or web access, applied the rule to a seeded random sample of 20 of the 61 mapped mechanisms and 5 of the 13 then judged covered. It saw the 68 mechanism-specific signals and the recorded scope of each mechanism's sources, not the sources and not the links. Claude models had proposed the links; ChatGPT models assisted with other parts of the paper. Over the 1,360 mechanism-signal pairs for the 20 mapped mechanisms, the rater made 49 of the paper's 52 links and 70 that the paper lacks (Cohen's kappa 0.55); two mechanisms matched exactly. Of the three links it did not make, the paper marks two as inference. Thirty-two of the 70 added links attach six general-purpose signals, such as request context and funds movement, to further mechanisms. The links are therefore a sourced subset: each gives a reason for a record, and other mechanisms may need the same record. Counts of links describe this subset, not a complete map. For four of the five covered mechanisms the rater named no missing record; for fake reviews (MP-08) it named review content, reviewer identities and posting histories. A second packet on 11 November gave the same rater the other eight covered mechanisms; it named no missing record for five and a missing record for three (API-09, API-10 and MP-11). The inventory was searched for each named record and none was found, so these four are now recorded as record gaps (S2) and the other nine remain covered. The check tests whether the rule reproduces the links from recorded source scopes. It is not a human coder and does not test the sources. The run record, answers and score are in the package.

Each input ID for the 24 derived features names another signal in the inventory. No feature depends, directly or indirectly, on itself. For example, SIG-24 uses SIG-27 to enumerate its eligible

transaction cohort, including completed payments with no report. The separate chargeback-or-alert-resolution measure also uses SIG-25. Keeping these inputs explicit makes the denominator and the distinction between measures inspectable.

The source directory identifies 61 design sources. Of these, 27 are not among the 127 cited works and have no S1 source note. Each source was read in full in October 2026. For one, a vendor blog post (L112), the cited passages were read verbatim and the other paragraphs only as a close paraphrase. One FTC complaint (L127) was first read in part on 21 October; a complete copy was read on 29 October. The directory records each source's type, the depth of the read, with qualifiers such as the version read or pages not read, the access date and the scope. Where only a preprint or an author copy was read, the row says so. Mechanism/source joins supply 126 links, each with its source identifier, recorded depth and scope limit. These records preserve the premises behind the mappings, including limits on transferring evidence from another setting.

The public-counterpart classification asks whether a pinned schema contains an object, field or event that supplies part of the required observation. Of the 71 signals, 32 have partial counterparts. The question does not apply to 32: 24 derived features, seven external-knowledge signals and one provenance signal. A keyword search of the three files identified no counterpart for seven, including request context, identity-capture session context and several agent observations. That absence is bounded by the terms searched. S5 gives the exact locators and explains the limits of partial counterparts; the inventory records each signal's classification.

Identifier links establish limited relationships. A storefront-to-merchant identifier link does not show that a payment through the merchant account settled. A verified identifier from the same namespace and relevant interval can support a stronger, or *hard*, link. A descriptor or shared IP address may support only a weaker, or *soft*, link. Neither alone establishes common control or malicious intent.

The inventory preserves the manuscript's interpretation rules: onboarding-link histories are a design analogy (S3.1), and error estimates retain their cohorts and denominators (Section 7.2). Each outcome channel retains its decision context (Section 7.1), and each broader outcome measure requires its own evaluation (Sections 8.2 and 9.1).

S3.1 How abuse mechanisms motivate the records

Manuscript Section 5.2 keeps the outcome-label records. The evidence for the other records follows.

Exposure and misuse require different evidence Measurements of exposed secrets establish exposure or validity at a particular time, not unauthorized use. Meli and colleagues found a median of about 1,800 unique candidate secrets daily. Of the monitored secrets, 81 percent remained sixteen days after discovery. They did not test credentials against the services [2]. Demir and colleagues confirmed 1,748 active credentials for 14 services, with payment services among the largest groups. Traced through nine archived crawl snapshots, the verified credentials had been publicly exposed for 12 months on average [3]. That duration does not show continuous credential validity.

The specification therefore records exposure location and time as external knowledge, then compares credential use before and after exposure. Public visibility, validity, attacker possession and misuse remain separate propositions.

Timing can matter at minute scale. In a deliberate cloud-key exposure experiment, an actor used the key within minutes while an automatic quarantine limited its actions. Researchers later removed that restriction to observe further operations [4]. Microsoft reported attackers launching

follow-on payment fraud attempts as little as five minutes after stealing credentials and session cookies through phishing that relayed the victim's login [5]. These observations motivate precise timestamps without establishing typical attack speed.

Access needs a history A login challenge is an extra verification step at sign-in. Research examines challenges triggered by unfamiliar devices and networks [6]. The design records authentication context, session issuance and later use. Applying the same lifecycle to onboarding links, which let businesses complete account setup, is a design analogy.

Changes after access can identify what an intruder attempted. In reported OAuth-application abuse, intruders used compromised accounts to create applications, grant them permissions, add credentials to new and existing applications and create inbox rules that hid messages from the user [7]. The design records these changes, with links to source observations. Recording changes to authentication factors and event destinations extends the same approach.

A device or browser fingerprint can help connect activity but cannot alone establish common control. One impersonation market sells stolen user profiles with browser fingerprint data and a browser extension meant to reproduce them. The study did not buy profiles to test that software [8]. The records retain that uncertainty.

Funds movements need destination histories The FBI's payroll-diversion advisory describes attackers changing where funds are sent [9]. Payout destinations therefore have their own identities and histories: creation, changes, first observation, validation and reuse across accounts. Trace A applies this analogy to a hypothetical key permitted to change a payout destination.

Regulatory guidance motivates measures of time between receipt and onward transfer, and concentration at receiving entities [10]. It does not validate a per-account detector.

Business descriptions need corroboration Storefronts, merchant accounts and statement descriptors, the merchant names cardholders see, need not map one-to-one. ScamMagnifier linked fraudulent storefronts through merchant identifiers, with a provider corroborating some links. Its checkouts stopped before purchase and did not observe settlement [11].

Studies of abusive merchants describe misdeclared business categories and movement between banks [12, 13]. FTC complaints allege pooling or spreading transactions across accounts to evade monitoring, and misleading representations [14–16]. The design consequently links storefronts, descriptors, account histories and verified ownership records. It retains declared business details with their source and time for comparison with activity. These allegations and links motivate investigation; they do not establish intent or ownership in a new case.

End customers are not platform accounts A legitimate business may have abusive customers. Stripe's public documentation describes multi-accounting, account sharing, free trial abuse, account farming and deliberate non-payment for accrued usage [17–20]. The customer-evaluations page describes its reuse reasons as reuse within one business over the past seven days; the account-farming page does not specify whether its links span businesses.

The specification records end-customer registration and billing histories, reused identifiers, simultaneous use and unpaid usage within a business. Linking an end customer's identity across businesses requires separate authorization, a permitted purpose, privacy oversight and supporting evidence. This restriction does not prohibit authorized fraud-prevention aggregation on instruments, devices or credentials under a stated and logged scope.

S4. Responsibilities, entities and interfaces

The 71 signals identify candidate records, the 24 responsibilities assign investigation and review functions, and the interfaces preserve the meaning of what passes between them. The functional responsibilities file defines them without requiring separate processes or databases. Seventeen were derived with payment-specific mechanisms or sources in view. One (23) adapts agent-security research, and six (2, 3, 4, 13, 21 and 22) come from cyber threat intelligence work. These origins describe how the responsibilities were derived, not uniqueness to payments. The file's `class` column marks these three groups DI, AGV and INH.

Responsibilities 16 and 17 cover engineering validation and adaptive testing of detections, controls and models. Responsibility 21 independently reviews all agent outputs, including intelligence drafts, hunting and detection candidates, and recommendations; responsibility 22 provides human release. Permission to investigate grants no authority over accounts, payments or controls. An authorized human may decide urgent containment before quality review (manuscript Section 6.4), without releasing the draft into organizational memory.

Responsibilities 1 to 10 scope and conduct an investigation. They include human tasking, governed tools, the evidence store, hypothesis testing and entity relationships. Responsibilities 11 to 20 represent threat knowledge and turn findings into usable outputs: actor, technique and vulnerability knowledge, the structured threat-knowledge store, hunting for undetected abuse, detection development, threat-model integration, recommendations, finished-intelligence synthesis and evidence lineage. Responsibilities 21 to 24 govern use and reuse: independent quality review, human release, controlled learning and security of the investigation system.

The entity inventory and entity relationships define the entities and the kinds of links between them. Each link records its source, identifier namespaces and the basis for associating each identifier with its entity. It retains its effective interval, learned time, version, confidence, confounders (other explanations for the link), and permitted purpose and scope. A shared attribute alone does not establish that one person controls both entities. When a decision makes an outcome unobservable, the record describes the channel's status; it does not invent an outcome report. S4.1 gives the complete storage requirements, and S4.2 gives field-level schemas for the outcome records.

The query interface must show what each query actually covered and what its result means:

Part of the interface	Information or behavior required
Request	Task and question; authorized requester; tenant, purpose and data scope; entity namespaces; event interval and as-of cutoff (only data the system had learned by then); schema and query versions; row, time and cost limits; expected observation and required coverage
Response	Query/run ID; scope actually evaluated; source and schema versions; event and ingestion watermarks (how far event time and data loading had progressed); known gaps and retention horizon for each source; sampling and access filtering; whether the result is complete, partial, truncated, denied or unavailable, and any scope-limited flag; meaning of any count; returned rows or approved aggregate, with the identifiers of the returned records kept for the run; lineage and coverage limits
Interpretation	A positive observation does not establish how many cases exist in the population. An empty result counts against a hypothesis only when the abuse should have produced the queried observation and the records cover where it would appear. A denied or unavailable result does not establish adversary behavior.

Part of the interface	Information or behavior required
Failure	Enforce limits outside the agent's language model. Stop or narrow the query after it exceeds a row, time or cost limit, or after an authorization error. Record incomplete tests and any abstention (a decision not to conclude). Do not treat missing or not-assessed data as low risk.

Some permitted operations also need approval bound to the exact request payload, target, task, tenant, tool and tool-manifest version. The manifest is the declared list of the agent's tools. Each approval has an expiry and a rule governing reuse. At execution, the enforcement gateway (manuscript Section 6.5) checks that the operation matches the approval and remains permitted. The restricted agent-and-approval ledger records both approval and execution.

Control and outcome records distinguish the decision, its inputs and version, what happened next, the observable channels, actual reports and any review of correctness. Population error estimates retain their own cohort, denominator, outcome window, uncertainty and scope; they do not establish correctness for individual events. Late reports, unobservable outcomes and false reports have separate fields because they can coexist.

A hypothetical timeline illustrates the as-of cutoff. Freeze a prediction on day 0 using only information then known. A day-30 report may evaluate it within a stated outcome window, but a model trained on day 20 cannot use that report. A later training run may use it if the run's cutoff and label rules permit. Likewise, a relationship learned on day 10 cannot enter day-0 features merely because its effective date is earlier.

The draft schema supplies the fields that the rule checker, quality reviewers and the releaser use to assess an intelligence draft.

Returned records a draft does not cite (manuscript Section 6.4). The checker identifies every record that the case's query runs returned within a claim's scope but that the draft neither cites nor lists against it. It attaches those that a fixed rule marks as able to count against the claim, such as reports, reversals and records of the benign explanations the claim must exclude, and summarizes the rest by type and count. Reviewers and the releaser see both beside the claim. Full checks of claims about named entities examine every marked record and a recorded random sample of the rest, whose size is fixed in advance for each claim type, and E8 reports how often that sample contained a record that counted against the claim. If a share q of the unmarked records count against the claim, a random sample of m finds at least one with probability at least $1-(1-q)^m$: 59 records give 95 percent when q is 5 percent.

Event timing in drafts (manuscript Section 6.4). A time asserted by a business, customer or external source retains its source and uncertainty. Recent receipt does not establish recent conduct when the event interval is unresolved. Outcome windows instead use each channel's declared clock-start event.

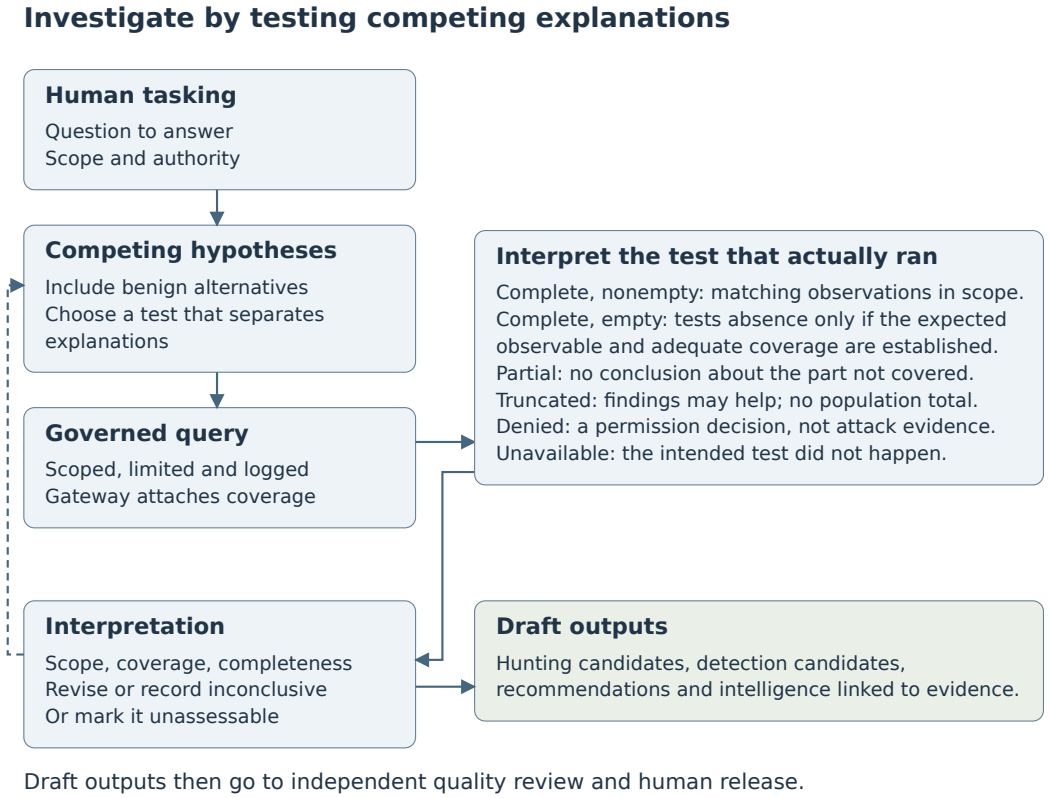
S4.1 Complete storage requirements

Table S4.1 summarizes this complete storage contract; S3.1 and manuscript Section 5.2 give the motivating evidence. Each block groups requirements by the information it preserves. The stores distinguish record meanings and need not be separate databases.

Table S4.1. What each analytical store preserves. The full contract is in S4.1. These are requirements for the proposed platform, not claims about an existing provider. The structured threat-knowledge and organizational-memory stores form their own planes, and the other stores hold evidence-plane records. Clusters in the entity-relation graph remain threat-knowledge items. External-knowledge records support only what their source observed or described, and ledger entries only what happened during the investigation itself.

Store or shared requirement	Required properties
Observation log	Source records and revisions, identifiers, environment, tenant scope and lineage; separate event, source-recording, ingestion and query-availability times; repeated delivery does not duplicate the event
Entity-relation graph	Typed identifier links with source, namespace, effective interval, learned time, version, confidence, benign explanations, and permitted purpose and scope; versioned cluster membership; end customers scoped to a business
Feature store	Recomputable inputs and versions; decision-time features exclude later information; later labels use the evaluation's outcome window and maturity; features inherit their inputs' agent-output and released-item links
Label store	Report source, type and attributed entity; occurrence, report and arrival times; appended value history; typed links to every decision that may have shaped the report; links to separate truth assessments and any informing agent output or released item; report presence, channel state and query access kept apart
Assessment store	Model or reviewer identity and version; review selection route and probability; links to any informing agent output or released item; unknown, not-assessed and failed-open states kept distinct from low risk; failed-open means an assessment failed and activity continued
Control-outcome store	Decision, authority, reason and version; reproducible available inputs; alternative-decision probabilities where applicable; human assignment and what the decider was shown; links to any informing agent output or released item; effects on each outcome channel, fixed with the decision; for action before review, the urgent route, impact class and later review outcome; correctness reviews with their selection route, separate from population error estimates
Structured threat-knowledge store	Revisable relationships and conclusions with confidence, input and rule versions, writer and status; agent proposals marked as unreleased context; links to informing agent outputs and released items
Organizational-memory store	Human-released items with approved claims and their stated confidence, version, scope, expiry, reviewer findings, lineage and correction links; exonerating items have independent counterexamples, a re-test date and the evidence and cluster versions whose change expires them early; proposed lessons wait outside it with their counterexample tests, and released lessons keep monitoring and withdrawal records
External-knowledge store	Source, type, times observed and published, validity period, retrieval time and license; a link to the released item whose identifier the returning content bears
Agent-and-approval ledger	Model, instructions, inputs, tool calls; approver, binding, expiry and reuse rule of each approval; approved and executed payloads, tool-manifest version and hash at approval and at execution, memory writes, outbound-traffic decisions; rule-checker and reviewer findings per draft version; marked untrusted content and exposed agent output; logged agent-output and released-item link removals
Query coverage record	Gateway-written entities and intervals, requested and evaluated; as-of cutoff, schema versions, sampling, per-source watermarks, known gaps and retention horizon, access filtering and limits reached; derived result status; not writable by the agent
Shared time and graph requirements	Reconstruct what was available at each decision; preserve reporting clocks and delays, retention limits, account histories and report-to-transaction links

Figure S4.1. Investigation as a sequence of tests. Each query tests competing explanations within authorized scope. A gateway outside the agent attaches the query's coverage, which determines which interpretations remain supported. Draft outputs follow review and release under manuscript Section 6.4.



Observation log

- Preserve records and revisions without overwriting earlier records. Keep source, event and delivery identifiers, schema version, entities, source lineage, and actor and request identifiers where available. A record delivered more than once takes effect only once.
- Record each observation's environment (production, test, synthetic, replay or emulation), marked when the record is created, and its tenant scope: the business or other boundary within which it may be accessed and used. Keep each record's source trust mark. Mark content that businesses, customers or outside sources supplied as untrusted. Both marks survive normalization and storage.
- For content fetched from a source the subject controls, such as a storefront or business website, record the vantage point of each fetch: network origin, region and client. A subject can serve different content to different visitors, including reviewers.
- Mark every label, assessment, control outcome, draft, proposed lesson and released item that a test, replay or emulation creates, or that derives from such a record or from synthetic data, with the same environment value when it is created. Keep these records out of production labels, intelligence and lessons. Record any authorization for their evaluation use, with who gave it, the evaluation and its scope.

- Keep event or effective time (when something happened or took effect) with its source and uncertainty bound. Record the source system's recorded time and the platform's ingestion time separately.
- For each store, retain when each record and revision became visible to queries.
- A derived record keeps its inputs' latest learned time separately from the time it first became queryable. Its own learned time is the latter and cannot precede any input's learned time.

Entity-relation graph

- Label each identifier link by kind and as hard (stronger) or soft (weaker). Retain its source, identifier namespaces, effective interval, learned time, version, confidence and possible benign explanations (confounders).
- Record why each identifier is believed to belong to its entity.
- Keep versions of linked-entity clusters and their membership rules. Record end customers separately for each business. Record each link's permitted purpose and scope. A link across businesses also records its authorization for that identifier type (manuscript Sections 5.2 and 5.5).

Feature store

- Keep inputs traceable and values recomputable, with the feature definition version, the entities and the computation window. Decision-time features use only information available at that decision.
- A feature computed over a cluster or other threat-knowledge item records that item's version, writer and status. If an agent proposed the item, or the item links to an agent output or released organizational-memory item that informed it, the feature links to that output or item and counts as dependent on it.
- Join later outcomes as evaluation labels under an explicit outcome window and maturity period. The outcome window is the period after the decision in which an outcome must occur to count.

Label store

- **Report history:** retain report type, source, attributed transaction or entity and lag. Keep three times: when the reported outcome occurred, where known, with its uncertainty; when the report was made at its source; and when it arrived at the platform. Preserve each value and its learned time, such as a dispute being filed, answered, then won or lost, and record whether each won or lost status followed adjudication. Append each status change, reversal or correction as a new record that references the earlier one. Never edit an earlier record, so that what the platform believed at each time can be reconstructed.
- **Truth assessment:** link any assessment that the report is mistaken or deliberately false. Keep that assessment in the assessment store with its model or reviewer identity and version, how the report was selected for review and, for a sampled review, its selection probability.
- **Dependencies:** link every decision that may have shaped the report, and any agent output or released organizational-memory item that informed the label. A report may link to several decisions, such as a blocked attempt, a retry and the approval of the paid attempt, and one decision, such as an account restriction, may link to many reports. Each link states the decision's role, such as a decision on the reported item, on an earlier related attempt, or on an account or payout that contains it, and the basis for the link. Record the writer's case or session and the agent outputs and released items open in it when the record was written.
- **Channel status:** for each affected transaction, payout or account application, keep report presence, channel state and query access separate at each read time. These statuses may be

computed when read from the stored decision, report and channel records. When a draft cites a status, store that status with an identifier and its read time.

- **State history:** a channel is open, temporarily delayed or not yet opened, permanently closed by a recorded decision, reopened or extended by a recorded rule event, or unknown. Keep every transition's effective interval and the decision ID, or the rule event's source and version, that caused it.
- **No report:** an open channel remains pending before its reporting window ends. It matures with no report only if it stayed open throughout the window and the records cover that window. If a recorded decision or rule event changed the channel's meaning, the matured absence carries that decision's ID, or the rule event's source and version, and is read under the changed meaning, not as a negative for the original outcome. A channel with no defined window never supports a negative by maturity alone. A matured absence is provisional: it records the rule version under which it matured and returns to pending if a later rule event reopens the window.
- **Unavailable records:** mark inaccessible records unavailable without overwriting known channel state or earlier reports.
- **Clocks and maturity:** for a temporary delay, keep the expected and actual clock-start events when known. Store the reporting window and clock-start event with the channel, including their source and version. Each channel record also names its rail, the attributes its window depends on, such as whether the debited account is a consumer or business account or the type of claim, and whether the channel adjudicates report truth. Store the maturity used by an evaluation with that evaluation.

Program status and reopened reports (manuscript Section 5.3). A decision can change a channel's meaning, as a liability shift after successful authentication does (manuscript Section 7.1). A merchant's network program status can also change that meaning: under one program, a merchant loses the liability shift on domestic authenticated payments until it exits the program [21]. The records keep that status as it stood at decision time, because the guide does not say whether the loss reaches payments authenticated before the merchant entered the program. A report's resolution is not always final either: in rare cases an issuer files a further dispute on the same payment after acquiring new information, or a lost dispute later becomes a late win [22].

Bank-debit and other rails (manuscript Section 7.1). A SEPA Direct Debit dispute within eight weeks of the debit is honored with no questions asked, and such disputes are final, with no process for appeal [23]. After eight weeks and up to 13 months, a customer can dispute only a debit considered unauthorized, and the customer's bank decides; the window that applies therefore depends on the claim, and an absence at eight weeks is not a negative for unauthorized-debit fraud [23]. Inside its window, an ACH return is refunded without question, and the ACH Network has no appeals process of its own [24]. A SEPA dispute honored with no questions asked is not by itself a fraud allegation. For ACH returns, Stripe's terms give 60 days for consumer accounts and 2 days for business accounts, counted from the customer's bank statement [24], while the Nacha return deadlines that banks apply run from the settlement date of the original debit [25]; a channel record therefore names the rule from which it takes its clock start. Banks may also accept late returns outside the window [24].

Limits of the rail review (manuscript Section 9.2). Bank debits were compared only with two of Stripe's pages and one bank's return-code table (manuscript Section 7.1); of the bank-debit candidates in S2, PAY-07 was judged covered and MM-03 was not reviewed. Instant push payments and stablecoin payments, which are also in the product scope, were not reviewed rail by rail; their mechanisms MM-07 and MM-12 were reviewed, but not their reporting channels (S2).

Assessment store

- Retain the model or reviewer identity and version. Keep unknown, not-assessed and failed-open states distinct from low risk.
- Record when each assessment was made and frozen (its freeze time) and the as-of time of its inputs. For each model version, record its training and model-selection cutoff and the label rules it used. A label that became available after that cutoff cannot enter that version.
- Never store an assessment as an observation of the conduct it assesses.
- Link each assessment, whether a model, a detection or a reviewer produced it, and each detection or model version, to any agent output or released organizational-memory item that informed it. Record the writer's case or session and the agent outputs and released items open in it when the record was written.
- For each detection or model version, link the validation records of responsibilities 16 and 17, with their version, date and result.

Control-outcome store

- **Decision:** retain the decision, who had authority to make it, the rule or model version, and the reason.
- **Inputs and policy:** log the time of the decision and the inputs it used. Keep versions from which every other input available at that time can be reconstructed. Record the score, threshold or rule that produced the decision, and whether the policy was deterministic and, otherwise, the probability of each alternative. Identify any input that a decider, automated or human, used but that was not logged.
- **Human decisions:** retain who decided, how the case was assigned and what the decider was shown.
- **Dependencies:** link any agent output and any released organizational-memory item that informed the decision, so the decision can be revisited when that item expires or is corrected or retracted. Record the writer's case or session and the agent outputs and released items open in it when the record was written.
- **Correctness:** record reviewed correctness when available, with how the case was selected for review (for example an appeal, a complaint, a sampling rule or review of every case) and, for a sampled review, its selection probability; otherwise record unknown.
- **Error estimates:** keep separate links to each estimate, with its control version, cohort, outcome window, denominator, uncertainty and scope. The cohort is the fixed set of decisions the estimate covers.
- **Channel effects:** record the decision's effect on each outcome channel as closed, delayed, changed in meaning, none or unknown. Fix these effects when the decision is recorded. Record later state transitions, including rule events, as separate records that never edit the decision.
- **Restrictions:** distinguish allowing and blocking from restrictions, such as a hold that may later be released.
- **Urgent containment:** for an action decided before quality review (manuscript Section 6.4), record that route, the impact class (none, degraded service or outage), any notification and restoration path, the review deadline and the later review's outcome, including any reversal.

Structured threat-knowledge store

- For inferred relationships, clusters, technique mappings and conclusions, retain confidence and the input and rule versions that produced them.
- Record the writer as a correlation engine, agent proposal or person, and status as proposed, accepted or retracted. Record the person or accountable process that accepted or retracted the item, and when.
- Retrieve an agent-proposed item only when it is marked as an unreleased agent inference. It never counts as corroboration.
- Link an item that a person or correlation engine wrote to any agent output or released organizational-memory item that informed it. Record the writer's case or session and the agent outputs and released items open in it when the item was written. The item counts as dependent on those outputs and items.

Organizational-memory store

- Keep released items only, with the releaser, version hash, released claims and the confidence stated for each, scope, expiry, reviewer findings and originating draft.
- Retain supersession and retraction links, and lineage from every cited observation to its root record. Keep every later status record for a released item, such as a monitoring finding, an early expiry, a retraction or a withdrawal, with who or what wrote it and when.
- For benign or exonerating items, keep a re-test date, a source of counterexamples independent of the writer, and the versions of the cited evidence and of any cluster the item concerns. A revision of that evidence or a change in that cluster's membership expires the item early (manuscript Section 6.5). Record each re-test, with its counterexamples' sources, its result and its date.
- Read each item as context or a hypothesis, never as an observation.
- Proposed lessons remain outside organizational memory until testing, quality review and human release. For each one, record its writer, proposal time, queue state, intended scope and version. Record each test against counterexamples, with the counterexamples' sources and the result. After release, record monitoring findings and any withdrawal, each with its writer and time, and the reason for a withdrawal (manuscript Section 7.3). The requirement for responsibility 23 in the functions file calls a withdrawal rollback; the two terms name the same record.

External-knowledge store

- Retain source, type, version, when the source observed and published the fact, validity window, license and retrieval time. For a catalog of abuse techniques, the version is the fixed version that mappings cite.
- Keep external knowledge distinct from platform observations.
- Record the identifier attached to each released item shared outside the platform. When external content returns with that identifier, link it to that item. It counts as dependent on the item and on any agent output behind it, not as independent corroboration.

Agent-and-approval ledger

The ledger makes the agent itself investigable (manuscript Section 6.5).

- For each run, record the human assignment or the standing task template and version that authorized it, with its permitted data, entities, period, current period and outputs. The current period bounds claims about current conduct.
- For each tool call, preserve the provenance of inputs that reached the agent's language model.

- For each approval, keep the approver, the target, task, tenant and tool it is bound to, its expiry, its reuse rule and any token issued. Keep hashes of the approved and executed payloads, and the tool-manifest version and hash in force at approval and at execution.
- Record memory writes and decisions on outbound traffic.
- Record each agent output, such as an intelligence draft and each of its versions, a hunting or detection candidate or a recommendation, with its identifier, version hash, run and creation time. It is an observation of what the agent did, not evidence of the activity under investigation.
- Retain model identity and version, instruction version and decoding settings.
- Mark content that came from untrusted input as untrusted when it is read back. Distinguish copied untrusted content, agent output exposed to untrusted content and agent output without that exposure; exposure takes precedence. Ordinary source observations retain their own trust marks and are not assigned an agent-output category.
- Record each rule-checker result and quality-review finding with the draft's version hash, the rule version or reviewer, including the version of the rule that marks uncited returned records, and the draft's resulting status: returned, released or expired. For each quality review, record the materiality tier applied to each claim, the sampling rate, the cited records the reviewer examined and the random sample of unmarked uncited returned records it drew, whose size is fixed in advance for each claim type. Record when each draft version entered the review queue and when it would expire from it. For each review, record its start and end times.
- Record each removal of an agent-output or released-item link from a label, control decision, detection, assessment or threat-knowledge item, with the person who removed it, that person's release authority, the time, the reason and the identifier of the removed output or item.
- Store references to card data, identity documents and other regulated data, not copies (manuscript Section 5.5).

Privacy and operating constraints (manuscript Section 5.5). A deployment must specify retention and deletion for each record class before collecting it. Append-only logs preserve history but must still permit required deletion of personal payloads, derived data, backups and identifying lineage. Encryption-key destruction is sufficient only if recoverable keys and plaintext copies are also removed. Retained audit structure must not preserve information required to be deleted.

In the agent-and-approval ledger's references to regulated data, tokens or keyed hashes may be used only where the applicable standard permits. The ledger should not become a new sensitive-data store or widen payment-card security scope.

Use of external model providers depends on their processing terms and permitted processing locations. Drafts concerning suspicious-activity reporting remain subject to the platform's confidentiality and subject-notification rules.

Cross-business linking requires a stated purpose and authorization for each identifier type. Permission to use a payment-instrument link does not automatically authorize linking devices or verified people. These deployment obligations constrain the specification; this paper does not determine which legal basis applies in a particular deployment.

Query coverage record

- For each query run, retain its request: the task, run and question, the authorized requester, the tenant, purpose and data scope, the query version, the row, time and cost limits set, the expected observation and the required coverage.
- For each query run, retain the coverage record the gateway attached: requested and evaluated entities with their tenant and identifier namespaces, requested and evaluated event intervals,

as-of cutoff, source and schema versions, sampling, each source's event and ingestion watermarks, known gaps and retention horizon, access filtering, and any row, time or cost limit reached.
- Keep the derived result status (complete, partial, truncated, denied or unavailable), the version of the rules that derived it and any scope-limited flag. The agent cannot write these fields.
- For each query run, keep the identifiers of the records it returned, including those behind an approved aggregate, so that the checker can find returned records that a draft neither cites nor lists against a claim (manuscript Section 6.4). Keep identifiers, not copies, under each record's retention and deletion rules (manuscript Section 5.5).
- Link each tested hypothesis and each claim of absence to the query runs behind it. Record each hypothesis's status, including inconclusive and unassessable, apart from the query results. Record each incomplete test and each abstention.

Time semantics

- Use timestamps precise enough to join a key's exposure to its use within minutes, with each timestamp's clock source.
- For each payment, keep authorization, capture and processing times separately, and any service or event date that a channel rule uses as its clock start. Keep the authentication result and the reported liability status separately, each with its source, rule version and learned time. Keep any network program status that removes the liability shift as it stood at decision time. Record a later program entry as a rule event, and leave the liability status of payments authenticated before it unknown. An unknown liability status remains unknown.
- Preserve label delay and what information was available as of each time.
- Retain account age, dormancy and how long funds stay before moving on.
- For each record class, keep each record until the longest applicable reporting window, counted from its channel's clock-start event, or the defined maturity period has ended, whichever ends later, plus the investigative lookback period. Follow the retention and deletion rules in manuscript Section 5.5. Record resulting gaps as coverage limits. Record each authorized hold with its scope and retention rule.

Graph semantics

- Link closed accounts to suspected successor accounts, and storefronts to merchants.
- Link each outcome report to the transaction, payout or account application it concerns, with the basis for the link and whether it is verified. Attribute outcomes through that link to the platform account, connected account and end customer, so that a measure counts each affected transaction once. A report's links to the decisions that may have shaped it do not change this count. Keep each transaction's acquiring bank and the static part of its statement descriptor, so that a network's monitored unit can be reconstructed.
- Link each wallet to every party it has allowed to spend its funds.

S4.2 Field-level schemas for outcome records

The outcome-record schema defines, in JSON Schema, the fields of the records the first requirement needs. It covers eight record types:

Record	What it holds
OutcomeChannel	A route for reporting outcomes: its rail, clock-start event, reporting window with source and rule version, the attributes the window depends on, and whether the channel adjudicates report truth
ControlAction	A decision's targets, time, authority and version, and its effect on each channel: closed, delayed, changed in meaning, none or unknown
ChannelStateTransition	One change in a channel's state for one item, with its effective interval and the decision or rule event that caused it
LabelEvent	An outcome report or one revision of it, with its amount and whether the report states that amount or the platform estimated it, when the outcome occurred, when it was reported at its source, when it arrived and when it became queryable
LabelEventDecisionLink	A link from a report to one decision that may have shaped it, with the decision's role, the basis for the link and whether it is verified
ChannelStatusReading	Report presence, channel state, query access and no-report status for one item and channel at one read time, stored when a draft cites it
ItemAttribution	The accounts an item belongs to, and the acquiring bank and static statement descriptor from which a network's monitored unit can be rebuilt
EntityLink	A link between entities, such as a closed account and a suspected successor, with its basis, confidence and other possible explanations

Every record is append-only: a correction is a new record that references the earlier one. An unknown time is recorded as unknown, with a reason, and never left out. The schema checks each record on its own. Fourteen rules check records against each other:

1. OR-01: a record identifier is used once. A record changed in place under its own identifier passes every rule, so the store must prevent edits.
2. OR-02: a correction or revision references an earlier record of the same type and, for a report, of the same report.
3. OR-03: every channel, decision and report that a record cites exists.
4. OR-04: a report's times are in order where they are known: occurred, reported, arrived, learned.
5. OR-05: a won or lost report states whether that result followed adjudication.
6. OR-06: a decision gives one effect per channel. A delay gives its expected clock start, and a change in meaning says what changed.
7. OR-07: a permanent closure cites the decision that caused it, and a reopening or extension cites the rule event. A cited decision must target the item, record the matching effect and precede the transition.
8. OR-08: no report can arrive through a channel while a closure of that channel for that item is in force; a revision counts from its report's first arrival. Such a report means the item link or the closure is wrong.
9. OR-09: a link's role fits the decision: a decision on the reported item, on an earlier related attempt, or on an account or payout that contains the item.
10. OR-10: a reading's channel state is computed only from the transitions the system had learned by the read time.
11. OR-11: a reading's report presence matches the reports learned by the read time. Presence is unavailable only when query access was denied or unavailable, and it does not overwrite channel state.

12. OR-12: a no-report status follows from the channel's state and window. An absence matures only if the window is defined and has ended, the channel was open throughout it, with no gap in its recorded state, and query access was full. A matured absence records the rule version it matured under and cites any decision that changed the channel's meaning.
13. OR-13: each reported item has exactly one live attribution to its accounts, so a measure counts it once.
14. OR-14: a link resting only on a shared attribute is neither verified nor high-confidence, and a suspected-successor link starts from an account with a recorded closure.

The valid conformance case builds one synthetic history: a blocked card attempt, an approved retry that draws a fraud chargeback the merchant later wins, a hold on the account that received the payment, and a payment that draws no report. An earlier account with the same principal name was closed; the new account is linked to it as a suspected successor on that name alone, and a storefront is linked to the new account by its checkout identifier. Its 27 records pass. Each of the 24 invalid cases changes that history in one way and must fail exactly one check; together they exercise the schema check and all fourteen rules. `tools/outcome_conformance.py` runs the cases using only the Python standard library, and `CHECK_CANDIDATE.py` also runs it. The same tool checks any records file in this format.

Channel names, windows and rule versions in the cases are illustrative, not any network's rules. The schema follows the label-store, control-outcome-store and graph-semantics requirements in S4.1 and the relations in the entity-relationships file. A schema and passing synthetic cases do not show that the records improve investigations. S4.4 gives the schemas for query runs, which the second requirement needs, and for release records. Denominators are outside these records: which payments a measure counts, their amounts and their capture or settlement times come from the payment ledger, which this section does not specify. Whether a denominator read was complete is a query-coverage record.

S4.3 Cost of the outcome records on synthetic data

`tools/outcome_cost.py` builds one million synthetic payments from the valid conformance case, replacing identifiers and shifting times, so each record has its template's fields. Before measuring, it checks a sample of generated records against the schema and OR-01 to OR-14. The results come from one run on the machine below.

Assumptions, illustrative and not any platform's values: payments spread over 90 days; 100 payments per account; two outcome channels per payment, fraud chargeback and early fraud warning; 1 percent of payments blocked; 0.5 percent of allowed payments draw a fraud chargeback with three report events and one decision link; 1 percent of accounts held and 1 percent linked to a suspected predecessor; one cited channel reading per blocked payment.

Record	Records	Mean size (bytes, JSON)
ChannelStateTransition	2,000,000	411
ControlAction	1,000,200	422
ItemAttribution	1,000,000	397
LabelEvent	15,372	718
ChannelStatusReading	9,947	378
LabelEventDecisionLink	5,124	230
EntityLink	100	558

Record	Records	Mean size (bytes, JSON)
OutcomeChannel	2	361

Each payment needs 4.03 records. Per million payments: 1,656 MB as JSON lines; 79 MB compressed with gzip level 6; 2,559 MB in SQLite 3.53.1, storing each record's JSON with one index on item, channel, record type, learned time and effective time. On a two-core x86-64 virtual machine with Python 3.13.18: 10,000 reads of one payment's fraud-chargeback state and report count, at a cutoff after all records, took a median of 17 microseconds and a 99th percentile of 57; one day's cohort of 11,052 payments took 0.3 seconds. Loading took 125 seconds and indexing 2.7.

Limits: template text repeats, so compression overstates what real records achieve, and field values are longer than coded production values would be. Each added outcome channel adds one channel-state record per payment. The store is one SQLite file on one machine, not a production database. Query runs (C2) and release records (C3) are measured in S4.4.

S4.4 Field-level schemas for query runs and release

The investigation-record schema defines the records the second and third requirements need. It covers eight record types:

Record	What it holds
Actor	A person, or a process at one version, that writes records: a source system, pipeline, model, rule, agent, the gateway or a checker
QueryRun	One query and the coverage record the gateway attached: requested and evaluated entities and intervals, the as-of cutoff, each source's watermarks, known gaps, retention horizon and sampling, filtering, limits reached, the records returned and the derived statuses
Observation	A stored record with its class, event interval, learned time, producer, root observations, inputs and links to any agent output that informed it
DraftOutput	An agent draft: its exact version, expiry, the task's current period, and each claim with its supporting and contradicting records, query runs, context, and any items whose unreported outcome it relies on, with their channel readings
OutputExposure	A period in which a person had an agent output open about an entity
ReleaseDecision	A person's decision on one exact draft version: the claims released with their confidence, scope, expiry and reviewer findings
ReleasedItem	A released conclusion in organizational memory, usable as context only
MemoryRead	One read of a released item

Fourteen rules check records against each other:

1. IR-01: a record identifier is used once.
2. IR-02: every record a record cites exists, a cited query run is a query run, and a producer is an actor.
3. IR-03: a gateway that is not the requester records a query run's coverage.
4. IR-04: the evaluated entities and interval lie within those requested, and the as-of cutoff is not after the query.
5. IR-05: a run's statuses follow from its coverage fields. By Section 6.2's source rules, a run is partial when a source was sampled, has a known gap in the requested interval, or does not

reach from its retention horizon to its event watermark across that interval, and truncated when a limit was reached. Three rules are added here: a narrower evaluated scope, access filtering, or a source whose loading has not reached the end of the requested interval (its ingestion watermark) also gives partial. A denied or unavailable source gives that status. A run is complete only when nothing else applies.

6. IR-06: a run returns only records learned by its as-of cutoff whose event intervals overlap the evaluated interval.
7. IR-07: a derived record is learned no earlier than its inputs, and its root observations are exactly its inputs' roots. Only a source observation, score or decision can be its own root. A source observation is not learned before its event began.
8. IR-08: an absence claim cites at least one query run that is complete, not scope-limited, returned nothing and covers the claim's entities and interval. No cited run returned a record about those entities in that interval. A cited run that does not bear on that interval does not count against the claim.
9. IR-09: a claim's support consists of observation records about the claim's entities. Every record a claim cites, as support, contradiction, context or query run, exists by the time the draft was written. A supporting record is dependent, and adds no root, if it is linked to an agent output, names no producer, or lists no inputs and is not a source observation. The restriction runs through inputs: a derived record adds only the roots reachable through records that are not dependent. The claim's count of distinct roots equals the number of distinct root observations its supporting records add. A material presence or current-conduct claim cites at least one supporting observation that is not dependent and whose event interval overlaps the claim's interval. A released conclusion or a draft is never support.
10. IR-10: a current-conduct claim cites an observation or derived feature whose event interval falls within the current period. A score or decision does not count, and a record linked to an agent output counts only through an unlinked current-period input.
11. IR-11: a draft's version identifier is the digest of its claims. A person releases the exact draft version, after the draft was written and before it expires, without raising any claim's confidence.
12. IR-12: a conclusion enters memory only after a decision that released that claim.
13. IR-13: memory is read only from a released item, between its creation and its release's expiry.
14. IR-14: a note names its producer. A record its producer wrote about an entity while an agent output about that entity was open links to that output, and a record derived from a linked record keeps the link.

The valid conformance case builds one synthetic history: an investigation with three query runs, a draft with a current-conduct claim and an absence claim, a note written while the draft was open, a release by a second person, and a later case that reads the released conclusion as context and cites a new observation. Its 25 records pass. Each of the 39 invalid cases changes that history in one way and fails exactly one check; together they exercise the schema and all fourteen rules. Where a case changes a draft's claims, the draft is first given its new digest, so that only the intended check fails. Run `tools/investigation_conformance.py` to repeat the checks.

The same script checks four necessity pairs. Each pair is two histories that permit different conclusions but are identical once one group of fields is removed. In the first three pairs both histories pass the rules; in the fourth, the rules reject the history with no release decision.

Fields removed	The two histories	What differs
Query coverage (C2)	The same empty result, from a complete run and from a run reaching past its source's event watermark	Whether absence is supported
Learned time (C2)	The same observation, learned before a run's cutoff and after it	Whether the fact was known at the cutoff
Roots and inputs (C3)	A second supporting record derived from a different observation, and one derived from the first	Two root observations or one
Release decision (C3)	The same stored conclusion, with a person's release decision and with none	Whether reuse is permitted

A store without those fields cannot tell the two histories apart, so no rule applied to it can be right in both. The pairs show that each field group is needed; they do not show that the records are sufficient or that they improve investigations. The rules do not check released-item links on records written after a memory read, or whether a returned record bears on a claim. They compare a source's ingestion watermark with the requested interval, not with the run's cutoff. Three further gaps need fields the schema lacks. A query run does not record what was asked, so the rules cannot tell whether a complete run returned every matching record. Release scope is free text, so the rules cannot hold a release or a later read to it. A release names a person but carries no authenticated approval tied to the draft. No record rule can show that the person read the draft, and the schema has no class for a fact recorded ahead of its effective date. Identifiers, dates and versions in the cases are illustrative.

Requirements together. One further rule checks a claim against the outcome records of S4.2:

- XR-01: a claim that relies on an item's outcome not being reported lists the item and cites a channel reading of it taken by the time of the draft. Every cited reading of the item shows a matured absence, and a cited run that is complete and not scope-limited evaluated the item from its clock start to the end of its reporting window and returned nothing about it.

The joint case adds a later investigation to the valid histories of S4.2 and this section. A person releases a claim that card attempt PA-3 drew no fraud chargeback. The claim rests on a complete, empty run over the attempt's reporting window and on the reading that shows the window matured. Its four records pass, and each of four invalid cases fails XR-01 alone. Two pairs of histories show that each requirement is needed when the other two hold:

Requirements that hold	The two histories	What differs
C2 and C3	The same complete, empty run and released claim about one attempt, which the platform approved in one history and blocked in the other	Whether the absence is a negative
C1 and C3	The same matured reading and released claim, with a complete run and with a run over a label feed loaded only to 20 May	Whether the absence is a negative

In the first pair every investigation record is the same, and both stores pass their own rules; only the channel records differ, and XR-01 rejects the blocked attempt. In the second, IR-08 and XR-01

reject the stalled read. The rules cannot tell whether a claim relies on an unreported outcome it does not list, or which channels it should cite.

Adversarial test (10 and 11 November 2026). The invalid cases were written by the same hand as the rules. To test the rules from outside, a tester received the two requirements as the manuscript states them, the fourteen rules, the record fields and the valid history, and not the checker (packet). The tester was OpenAI's GPT-6 in a session without memory, project files or web access. It wrote 15 histories: 13 meant to break a requirement and still pass, and two meant to be legitimate and still be rejected. Against the rules as they then stood, 10 of the 13 passed and both legitimate histories were rejected. A separate session of the same model checked the ruling on each case and corrected three (rulings). Of the 10 that passed, eight were gaps in the rules and two fell under limits this section already stated. The most serious gaps: a material presence claim that cited no evidence passed, and a note linked to an agent output counted as an independent root. Of the two rejections, one was intended, because the design links any record written while an agent output is open, and one was a false rejection by IR-08. The rules above include the changes that followed, to IR-05, IR-07, IR-08, IR-09 and IR-11, and a correction to the wording of IR-10. Under them, nine of the 13 histories are rejected and the false rejection is gone. The four that still pass are the limits stated above: a draft that drops its link to a released item it read, a complete run that omitted a matching record, a release whose scope excludes its own claim, and a release that names a person who did not review. The 15 histories are kept as a regression test and the package check reruns them. The rules were revised on these same histories, and no held-out round has been run. The test assumes a fully compromised agent or record writer. No live model was attacked, so it says nothing about how often an agent is subverted. Claude wrote the rules and the first rulings. The tester and the reviewer of the rulings were separate sessions of the same model, and ChatGPT models also assisted with other parts of the paper.

Cost. `tools/investigation_cost.py` copies the valid case 100,000 times, each copy with its four query runs, seven stored records, two drafts, one exposure, one release decision, one released item and one memory read, and checks a sample against the rules. Per copy, the records take 8.6 KB as JSON: 3.5 KB for query runs, about 900 bytes each, and 2.6 KB for drafts, release and memory records. A thousand copies take 0.30 MB compressed and 9.8 MB in SQLite; repeated text makes the compressed figure a best case. On the two-core machine of S4.3, checking that an absence claim's runs are complete and cover it took a median of 38 microseconds (99th percentile 91), and checking that a memory read used a released, unexpired item took 30 (78). The results come from one run. Real coverage records list more sources per run, and reviewer time is not measured.

S4.5 Further safeguards for the investigation system

Hostile content copied into the ledger can attack a person investigating the agent itself. Untrusted status must survive storage and normalization.

Ledger copies and agent outputs may suggest hypotheses, but claims cite the underlying evidence-plane records. Their promotion into organizational memory still requires independent testing and human release.

The architecture does not include live adversary emulation. Any future use would require separate ethical, human and operational authorization, enforced scope, tamper-evident logs and test-data provenance.

Table S4.2. The agent's permitted capabilities and their evidential limits (manuscript Section 6.3). Task scope, permissions and resource limits apply throughout.

Capability	Information used	Boundary
Discover sources and schemas	Signal inventory, schemas of data stores, and records of counterparts in published API schemas	Finding a source does not grant access to it
Run governed queries	Permitted data stores, with scope limits, query limits and logging	Conclusions cover only the data and period the query examined. A denied query is not by itself evidence about the suspected abuse
Match records to entities and follow their links	Links labeled by type, known benign reasons for shared identifiers, and versioned clusters (computed groups of entities)	Propose relationships for assessment. A shared identifier does not by itself show common control. A cluster is the output of a computation, not an observed relationship
Reconstruct timelines	Credential exposure and later use, session issuance and later use, and account changes after access	Events close together in time do not prove that one caused the other
Interpret outcome labels	Report provenance, decision gates and links from reports to transactions	A missing report does not show that no abuse occurred
Generate hypotheses from published catalogs of abuse techniques	Mappings to a fixed version of each catalog	Naming a likely technique does not show that it was used
Draft hunting and detection candidates	Features, observations and outcome labels	A hunting candidate is a proposed search, not a finding. Detection candidates must still be validated under detection development and threat-model integration (responsibilities 16 and 17)
Recommend product or control changes	What each relevant control decision means, restriction options, what happens when a check fails, and protective actions	Authorized humans or accountable operational systems decide and act
Draft intelligence	Evidence with traceable lineage	Drafts require independent quality review and human release

S5. Pinned public schemas

Schema versions records the filenames, hashes, versions and counts at repository commit `18fa2cc768024b47789dc6fa243acd48478acac2`, dated 25 September 2026. All three files come from the public `stripe/openapi` repository. The commit message reads "Update OpenAPI for 2026-09-30.endive": the version strings name the API release the files describe, which postdates the commit. The `private_preview` in file C's name does not indicate access to private systems. Stripe publishes these files under the MIT License. That license governs the schema-derived identifiers and locators in the event-type and signal-locator files; the package's third-party notice reproduces it.

The pinned public schemas supply event identifiers, creation time and mode, but omit learned time and some actor, scope and lineage fields [26]. Stripe's canonical-logging account describes one summary record per request in each service, with identifiers and outcomes [27]. These are partial precedents; the specification does not require vendor field names.

A partial match can leave much of the required record unspecified. An onramp-session object, for buying crypto, and an event-destination configuration, which sets event delivery, both record current state without a complete matching lifecycle event stream. The crypto documentation describes an onramp webhook, a notification sent to another system, for status changes after creation and none at creation [28]. Neither the event types that the pinned schemas declare nor their lists of webhook-endpoint events name a crypto or onramp event [26]. A request ID likewise supplies neither full request context nor the history of an onboarding link's use.

File A is `latest/openapi.spec3.sdk.json`; B is `preview/openapi.spec3.sdk.json`; C is `preview/openapi.private_preview.spec3.sdk.json`. Paths are endpoint addresses. Resource schemas are component schemas with an `x-resourceId`; they describe kinds of objects. Some resource schemas in file C share an ID.

SDK file	Version	Paths	Resource schemas / distinct IDs	Event types
A	2026-09-30.endive	421	175 / 175	508
B	2026-09-30.preview	574	237 / 237	618
C	2026-09-30.preview	800	329 / 327	781

Event types lists the types declared under `x-stripeEvent` in each file. Each count includes 216 thin-event declarations whose names add `v1.` to a snapshot type in the same file. The counts exclude the older `event.type` list. Signal locators identifies each counterpart's file and location using slash-separated field names and list positions. Slashes within endpoint names and media types, such as `application/json`, remain unchanged, so adjacent slashes can occur, as in `/paths//v1/webhook_endpoints`. The file's `locator` column therefore does not hold standard JSON Pointers, which would write each such slash as `~1`.

The signal-locator file lists only the 32 signals with partial counterparts. For the seven with none identified, the classification rests on a keyword search of all three files, so a counterpart under other terms is not ruled out. That search covered eight signals: SIG-03, SIG-34, SIG-35, SIG-38, SIG-39, SIG-40, SIG-56 and SIG-68. Its terms were `camera`, `emulator`, `inject`, `liveness`, `selfie`, `capture_session`, `device`, `tamper`, `manipulat`, `spoof`, `presentation`, `jailbreak`, `rooted`, `virtual`, `agent`, `tool_call`, `tool`, `mcp`, `llm`, `prompt`, `model_context`, `manifest`, `tool_version`, `hash`, `signature`, `signed_request`, `web_bot`, `bot`, `verified_agent`, `attestation`, `memory`, `skill`, `egress`, `allowlist`, `proxy`, `outbound_request`, `request_log`, `user_agent`, `ip_address`, `tls`, `ja3`, `fingerprint`, `http_status`, `api_error`, `request_id`, `api_request`, `allowance`, `spender`, `permit`, `signing`, `erc20`, `smart_contract`, `token_approval`, `approve` and `unlimited`. It searched event types, schema names, paths, keys, enum values and descriptions. For SIG-03, identity-verification outcomes such as `selfie_manipulated` and the `require_live_capture` setting record no device, camera, emulator or injection context. For SIG-34, the `agent_details` fields name the agent behind a payment or token and file C has MCP keys for claimable sandboxes, but neither records a tool call or its input provenance. For SIG-40, an API key's `ip_allowlist` controls inbound use of the key, not egress. For SIG-56, the event envelope's request ID and idempotency key, an API error's `request_log_url` and aggregate API-error health alerts give no per-request context. For SIG-38, the search found the `agent_details` fields, which the signal-locator file records as its partial counterpart.

Every listed counterpart is partial. An event envelope (the wrapper around an event) supplies only some required provenance, and a score does not establish the behavior it scores.

S6. Hypothetical investigations and reproducible arithmetic

The synthetic cohort contains 400 completed transactions, 100 in each of four non-overlapping account cohorts. Each cohort fixes one account's transactions using the same definition and outcome window. These synthetic rows make the counting rules reproducible. They contain no report-arrival dates, so the ratios assume that every report on the four cohorts has arrived and cannot show reporting delay.

S6.1 Trace A: narrative

A repository scan finds a publicly visible API key. A human asks whether it enabled account compromise and payout redirection. The trace concerns a key not yet revoked, or activity before revocation; existing automatic revocation is outside this workflow.

Exposure alone shows neither that a secret is still usable [2] nor misuse. The agent therefore compares earlier requests with those after publication. A hypothetical repository record supplies publication time, separately from the later scan-detection time. Available earlier requests share a cloud-provider region and stable client fingerprint.

Nineteen minutes after publication, requests arrive through a residential proxy range, using a different fingerprint. They access account-profile and configuration endpoints. The deliberate exposure experiment motivates minute-scale investigation [4], but developer testing or an internal scanner remains a possible explanation.

The same burst creates a webhook endpoint, changes the payout destination and accelerates the payout schedule. A webhook receives the platform's event notifications. This trace assumes the key permits these changes. If destination changes instead require a dashboard session and additional authentication, the investigation would need evidence of session takeover. The payroll-diversion advisory motivates the destination-change mechanism by analogy [9].

The next day, delayed records show that the same verified destination identifier was attached to two other accounts before exposure. The matching namespace and interval support destination reuse, not common ownership or malicious intent. The agent checks account histories and ownership records for alternatives such as a legitimate business with several accounts or an intermediary receiving client funds.

Two limits change the conclusion. First, a requested seven-day baseline contains only two hours of earlier history. The change at nineteen minutes cannot be called the first misuse. Second, a detection already running on the platform froze its compromise assessment thirty minutes after publication, before the destination link was learned the next day. The link can inform the later investigation but cannot enter that earlier assessment.

The investigation prepares four outputs: a search for similar cases, a detection candidate linking exposure to use and destination changes, an intelligence draft, and recommendations for authorized action. A reversible payout pause or hold may follow the urgent path when the accelerated schedule appears. Credential rotation or revocation follows normal review.

Stripe's public risk guide describes pausing, delaying or holding connected-account payouts and extending payout schedules [29]. It does not define a pause-versus-hold distinction, so the specification treats both as reversible restrictions while recording which was applied. A deployment must confirm from its own permission model which credentials can change payout destinations and schedules, and what revocation would interrupt.

Table S6.1. The two investigations at a glance. Every observation is hypothetical. S6.1 and S6.2 identify the supporting research and how far its findings transfer to this setting.

Element	Trace A: exposure and possible payout redirection	Trace B: storefront links and possible dispute evasion
Trigger	An external observation of an exposed key	A platform risk assessment and a rejected application
First questions	Did use change after exposure? What requests and account changes followed?	Which storefronts share templates, descriptors or merchant identifiers?
Main analysis	Join events by time; examine the history and reuse of payout destinations	Examine hard and soft links, and outcomes linked to each transaction, across accounts
Benign alternatives	Developer testing from a new network or an internal scanner; a business with several legitimate accounts, or an intermediary receiving funds for several clients	A legitimate multi-brand business, shared template vendor or aggregator
Evidence limit	Payout redirection is reasoned about by analogy with payroll diversion; timing premises come from Microsoft's report of follow-on business email compromise payment fraud soon after session theft and a deliberate key-exposure experiment	Complaint allegations are not findings; resolving pre-dispute alerts can change chargeback ratios
What limited evidence cannot show	A partial baseline cannot show that there was no earlier misuse	Neither soft links nor a hard link from a verified identifier by itself establishes common control, intent or who is behind the activity
Proposed outputs	Hunting candidate; detection candidate with an evaluation plan; recommendations to consider rotating or revoking the credential and a payout pause or hold; intelligence draft	Cluster intelligence assessment; recommendation to review the newly onboarded merchant accounts linked to the storefronts; detection candidate built on hard links between storefronts and accounts
Who acts	Authorized humans or accountable operational systems decide. The urgent exception covers a reversible payout pause or hold; rotation or revocation follows normal review	Authorized humans or accountable operational systems decide whether to reject or terminate accounts; the agent does not

The detection candidate needs an appropriate outcome. A payout moves an account's balance to its payout destination, which here may be controlled by an attacker. It is not a card payment that can produce a chargeback. Possible outcomes include victim reports, returned or recalled transfers and confirmed incident findings. A permanent block prevents outcomes requiring completion; a hold may only delay them.

Victim reports and incident findings have no defined reporting window here. Those channels can supply confirmed positives but cannot reach "matured with no report." Evaluation must either justify a delay model, as conversion research does in its setting [30], or leave negatives unconfirmed. The recorded decision and channel states determine which interpretation is available.

The blocked payout in manuscript Table 2 (manuscript Section 8.3). Excluding the case is valid only for a rate explicitly restricted to completed transfers. Estimating outcomes over all attempted payouts retains it in the target population and must address its unobserved outcome.

S6.2 Trace B: narrative

A risk assessment and a rejected application identify similar storefronts. A human asks whether newly onboarded merchant accounts form an operation structured to evade dispute monitoring. The assessment selects a lead; the investigation must establish the underlying relationships.

Following the merchant-identifier approach used in storefront research [11], the hypothetical investigation links eleven storefronts sharing two templates and a descriptor pattern. They settle through four merchant accounts. A principal, a person who owns or controls a business, also appears on a closed account and the rejected application. Research and enforcement allegations motivate examining such returns after closure [12, 16]. Settlement relationships are stipulated here, not inferred from the cited study's uncompleted checkouts.

The next question is which transactions the outcome reports concern. For disjoint cohorts with the same outcome definition and window, the pooled ratio is a transaction-weighted average of the account ratios, so it lies between the lowest and highest (S6.3).

The synthetic example gives accounts A to D 100 completed transactions each. After linking reports to transactions, every account has two chargebacked transactions: `2/100 = 2%`. The pooled chargeback ratio is `8/400 = 2%`.

Fourteen transactions also carry pre-dispute alert-resolution flags. Two overlap with the eight chargebacked transactions. A separate chargeback-or-alert-resolution measure therefore counts `8 + 14 − 2 = 20` transactions, or `20/400 = 5%`. Adding flags without deduplication gives the incorrect `22/400 = 5.5%`.

On that broader measure, A and B each have `8/100 = 8%`; C and D each have `2/100 = 2%`. The pooled 5 percent conceals the higher values at A and B. On the chargeback measure, all accounts remain at 2 percent, so pooling hides no higher rate. Neither measure is a fraud rate, and the example assumes no monitoring threshold.

Attribution changes which account appears affected. The chargebacks on D001 and D002 are recorded at account-X, outside the four cohorts. Counting where reports were recorded shows D at `0/100`. Verified transaction links restore D to `2/100` without changing the 400-transaction denominator or counting either report twice.

Such a mismatch can be legitimate. In Stripe's Connect documentation, a dispute on a direct charge debits the connected account's balance. A dispute on a destination charge or on separate charges and transfers debits the platform's balance, even when the connected account is the business of record, and the platform can try to recover funds by reversing the transfer [31]. Merchant-of-record and payment-facilitator arrangements can therefore explain a report appearing elsewhere. A missing transaction link leaves the affected measure incomplete, rather than justifying an assumed attribution. Reports concerning transactions outside the four cohorts are excluded.

Network program rules as read. Stripe's monitoring guide describes Mastercard's Excessive Chargeback Program as dividing one month's chargebacks by the previous month's captured payments and applying a minimum monthly chargeback count. It describes Visa's Acquirer Monitoring Program differently: each month, Visa divides the previous month's disputes plus early fraud warnings by captured payments in that same month, and it also sets thresholds on the count of those

reports and, in one region, on their total value. The guide says both networks assign a report to the month in which they receive it, not the month of the original payment. For that Visa program, a transaction that appears in both the dispute report and the fraud report counts twice, and disputes resolved through pre-dispute products are excluded. Visa identifies a monitored account by the static part of its statement descriptor and its acquiring bank [21]. The guide describes itself as a general guide, not a comprehensive reference, so E3 applies each program as the network's own documentation states it (S7.1). Visa's program overview defines the ratio over card-not-present VisaNet transactions, with settled transactions as the denominator, while the guide speaks of captured payments; E3 follows the network's definition [32].

Thus resolving alerts can lower the program ratio, and growing volume can lower a period ratio while reports are still arriving. Splitting activity can also keep accounts below a count threshold even when their ratios are identical. Detecting that pattern requires cluster-level counts, not merely a pooled cohort ratio.

Small cohorts leave substantial uncertainty. Cohorts of 100 transactions cannot reliably separate 8 percent from 2 percent: S6.3 gives exact intervals and a test. Repeated customers or a shared operator may correlate transactions, making those intervals and the test overstate precision.

The linked storefronts still require an explanation. Shared templates and descriptors may reflect a legitimate multi-brand business or aggregator. Verified identifiers support specific relationships without establishing intent or common control. The agent may produce a qualified cluster assessment, an inconclusive finding, a proposed account review or a detection candidate. It cannot reject or terminate accounts.

The enforcement sources remain allegations [14–16], and storefront content remains untrusted input.

S6.3 Reproducible arithmetic

Consider non-overlapping cohorts with the same outcome definition and outcome window. Let $T_i > 0$ be account i's transaction count and D_i its count of distinct transactions with chargebacks. Then

$$r = \frac{\sum_i D_i}{\sum_i T_i} = \sum_i w_i r_i, \qquad r_i = \frac{D_i}{T_i}, \qquad w_i = \frac{T_i}{\sum_j T_j}.$$

The weights are nonnegative and sum to one, so the pooled ratio lies between the smallest and largest account ratios.

Any change to report links or outcome definitions must be stated. If it applies alike to every cohort, the weighted-average formula still holds. Under independent trials with a common rate, exact (Clopper-Pearson) 95 percent intervals are 0.24 to 7.04 percent for 2/100, 0 to 3.62 percent for 0/100, and 0.87 to 3.90 percent for 8/400. For 8/100, the interval is 3.52 to 15.16 percent. Fisher's two-sided test comparing 8/100 with 2/100 gives p = 0.10.

CHECK_CANDIDATE.py checks these calculations and excludes the +1-day destination-reuse link from the +30-minute assessment. It also checks identifiers, counts, feature lineage, citation-reference agreement and links between files. REPRODUCE.md gives build and verification instructions. These are checks of the supplied artifacts and arithmetic, not an evaluation of the proposed system.

Manuscript Table 2 uses eleven signals: SIG-04, SIG-15, SIG-16, SIG-18, SIG-20, SIG-24, SIG-25, SIG-32, SIG-56, SIG-58 and SIG-71. Their complete lineage inputs and the storage requirements

are also needed. These examples explain the required context without claiming that each named signal is uniquely necessary. The denominator requires the eligible completed-transaction cohort from SIG-27, including transactions without reports.

Context each row of manuscript Table 2 needs (manuscript Section 8.3). The first two rows need request coverage, credential exposure, destination history and learned times. The second row also needs the frozen assessment and its freeze time, which the assessment store holds; none of the eleven signals records it. The third needs the control's effect on each channel. The fourth needs verified report-to-transaction links, deduplication and versioned cluster membership, which Trace B builds from storefront-to-merchant links. The fifth needs the separation between observations and organizational memory.

S7. Evaluation conditions

These conditions explain the scope and comparisons behind the tests in S7.1. E8's release-gate test appears there alongside the other eight; S8 adds a practitioner study of conclusions and current practice.

E1. Do coverage and learned-time records reduce unsupported conclusions? The confirmatory test in S7.1 concerns cases with incomplete history or links learned late, with a stratum of cases with complete history for its non-inferiority measure. A broader timing study would compare minute-level joins with coarser timing across a realistic incident population. It would measure exposure-to-use and session-issuance-to-use intervals, detection or triage gains, collection costs and false alarms from benign changes. Microsoft's report of payment fraud attempts soon after session theft and the deliberate key-exposure experiment motivate precise timing; neither establishes its typical benefit.

E2. When can missing outcomes be estimated? Define the outcome channel, population and assumptions before selecting an estimator. Simulation can test behavior under known assumptions, including cases without overlap, where no comparable cases received another decision. It cannot verify those assumptions or recover unknown real outcomes. Later observational comparisons must separate populations with supported overlap from those whose outcomes cannot be estimated. Test sensitivity to late, mistaken and deliberately false reports. Allowing attempts that a policy would otherwise block requires separate ethical, human and operational authorization. The motivating theoretical preprint proposes methods; this paper claims no recovery of missing outcomes on platform data [33].

The four assumptions (manuscript Section 7.1). An observational evaluation justifies four assumptions linking observed decisions to alternatives [34]:

- **Consistency:** each compared decision is precisely defined, and a case's observed outcome equals its outcome under the decision actually taken.
- **Conditional exchangeability:** after conditioning on logged history, cases receiving different decisions have no remaining differences that bias the comparison.
- **Overlap:** comparable cases had a nonzero chance of each relevant alternative decision.
- **No interference:** changing one attempt's decision does not change other attempts' outcomes, including retries.

If all decision inputs are logged and remaining decision variation is independent randomization, conditional exchangeability holds given those inputs. In practical terms, the logged history must account for variables influencing both decision and outcome [34]. Unlogged inputs used by a decider

Table S7.1. Requirements for interpreting feedback.

#	Problem	Evidence basis	Required response
1	A decision can close or delay an outcome channel, or change its meaning. Effects differ by channel; payout holds do not delay disputes.	Platform documentation that capture gates fraud reporting and that authentication can shift dispute liability; a theoretical payments preprint; established principles for inferring outcomes under a different decision	Record the decision and its effect on named outcome channels; state the assumptions needed to estimate unobserved outcomes
2	Reports can arrive late; this paper does not establish maturity periods	Theory and deployed-system evidence of delay	Preserve reporting clocks and arrival times. Reconstruct decision inputs as of the decision. Apply the evaluation's separate outcome window and maturity period to later labels.
3	Some reports or their supporting evidence may be fabricated	Theory and interview research	Keep report type and source with the label; keep any estimate that the report is mistaken or deliberately false as a linked assessment, not a field of the report
4	Controls can wrongly restrict or block legitimate users	Peer-reviewed evaluations	Keep decisions, reviews of their correctness and population-level error estimates separate; weigh detection gain against the cost to legitimate users
5	Adversaries can adapt to controls and testing	Platform publication, peer-reviewed measurement and preprint	Test adaptively within responsibilities 16 and 17; keep test traffic hard for adversaries to recognize but identifiable within the system
6	Decisions a business reports to the platform may carry the business's errors into platform labels	Platform documentation of business-reported decisions (manuscript Section 7.1); inference that they may carry errors	Keep decisions and outcomes reported by businesses distinct from platform labels
7	Account structures can hide which transactions and entities a report concerns	Enforcement allegations	Keep the links from each report to its transaction and entities; compute defined metrics for each cluster of related accounts; measure a closure's effect across the cluster
8	Payments a business or platform funds itself can inflate a ratio's denominator	Enforcement allegations	Exclude them from the denominator; count them separately
9	Resolving a pre-dispute alert may avert a later chargeback	Platform documentation that a refund can prevent a dispute; enforcement allegations for the misuse	Record alert resolutions separately; do not read a lower chargeback ratio, by itself, as less abuse
10	A risk assessment may return a not-assessed result or fail open (let the activity proceed)	Platform documentation	Keep unknown and failure states distinct; do not convert either into low risk

break that guarantee and must be identified. Repeated decisions require the relevant conditions at each step because earlier decisions can change later inputs [34].

Examining assumptions is not validating an estimator (manuscript Section 7.1). Three target quantities illustrate the distinction:

- **Candidate-policy value:** the average outcome a proposed decline policy would produce on a stated measure. Estimation from another policy's logs needs decision inputs, probabilities and overlap for the decisions the candidate would take.
- **The chargeback rate if all cases were allowed:** this needs comparable cases with some chance of being allowed. A class always blocked supplies no allowed comparison.
- **A control's error rate:** this needs a defined cohort, outcome window and denominator, with correctness reviewed for every case or a random sample with recorded selection probabilities. Appeals alone do not establish a cohort rate.

Decision records and added assumptions (manuscript Section 7.1). For each decision, the specification records available inputs, the score, threshold or rule, policy version and alternative-decision probabilities where the policy is not deterministic. Human decisions also record the decider, case assignment and information shown. Comparing human deciders of different leniency also requires random case assignment for the cited evaluation approach [35]. For delay, an evaluation specifies a distribution and period of stability. It assumes that, given recorded case attributes and channel, reading time is unrelated to when the report would arrive. For false reports, a noise model specifies error rates by decision, channel and reporter where relevant. Rates come from a random sample reviewed for truth or are stated as bounds.

E3. Do report linkage and cluster monitoring reveal evasion earlier? Compare the network's monthly rule, its ratio, its minimum count and any minimum value, applied to each account as reports are recorded, with the same rule applied to each cluster after linking reports to transactions. In S7.1, each mention of the network's ratio for E3 means this complete rule, including its minimum count and any minimum value. When every account has captured payments in the denominator period, a pooled ratio cannot exceed the highest account ratio, so a lead from clustering can come only from a condition on totals, such as the minimum count or, where the network sets one, a minimum value. An account with no captured payments in the rule's denominator period has no defined ratio when it receives reports, and the cluster ratio can then exceed every defined account ratio. Report separately any cluster flag that depends on reports received by an account with no captured payments in that period, such as a closed account or, where the denominator is the previous month's captured payments, an account in its first month. Keep the eligible transactions, outcome definition and reporting periods consistent. Apply the account arms to platform and connected accounts and, where a network monitors a different unit, such as Visa's static statement descriptor and acquiring bank, also to that unit. Evaluate broader measures, including chargeback-or-alert-resolution, separately. Apply each program's exclusions as the network's documentation states them, such as VAMP's exclusion of fraud reports that qualify for Compelling Evidence 3.0. State whose report view each arm uses: the programs also count disputes that Stripe handles on a business's behalf and that do not appear in that business's data [21]. Report the share of reports linked to transactions, the share whose link is unverified and how duplicate reports were removed. Report erroneous links between unrelated accounts sharing IP addresses, such as through a common proxy, as a secondary measure; S7.1's failure criteria do not include it [36].

E4. Can the records measure harm to legitimate users? The feasibility test in S7.1 asks whether control changes have computable harm rates and intervals. It precedes E1 to E3 and

E9. A broader evaluation would compare detection gains with failed attempts and other costs to legitimate users. The identity-verification and login-challenge studies report user outcomes under their own procedures [6, 37]. Their rates cannot determine whether a proposed payment control is worthwhile and require justification before transfer to this platform.

E5. Does the agent improve the investigation? Compare the governed agent with well-equipped human investigators and suitable decision rules, including simple thresholds where appropriate. Sharma's agent underperformed its underlying classifier's threshold on 60 synthetic cases [38]. That limited result motivates testing the agent's added value. Give each approach the same information, set escalation rules in advance and include adaptive adversaries. The storage contract holds reviewer times only for work recorded in the agent-and-approval ledger.

E6. Do the agent's safeguards hold under adaptive attack? Test prompt injection, approval rebinding (reusing approval for an altered operation), memory poisoning and limits on outbound data. Measure security failures and the effect of safeguards on investigations completed. Prior adaptive attacks motivate this test but do not establish that these safeguards work [39]. One proposed defense separates control flow, the steps an agent chooses, from untrusted data [40]. It is a candidate for evaluation under its stated assumptions. Adopting it would change the single hypothesis loop in Figure S4.1, which currently makes no such separation.

E7. Can lessons be reused without spreading mistakes? Measure time to useful reuse, negative transfer (a lesson degrading later investigations) and poisoning. Vary validation strictness, release scope and withdrawal conditions. General-purpose agent research supplies methods and evidence of failures, not payment-platform results [41, 42]. Poisoned evidence might suggest a legitimate merchant-of-record arrangement, where one business sells on behalf of others. An honest agent could then propose a lesson steering later investigations away from that infrastructure.

E9. Do channel states reduce error against a mature holdout reference? S7.1 gives the design: labels built under three readings on decisions the platform already logs, and each reading's error against a holdout reference. The motivating theoretical preprint models reporting and maturity for one channel [33]; E9 asks whether recording several channels' states matters on platform data.

Record the provenance of synthetic, replayed and emulated data when created. Agent-driven adversary emulation would also require the authorization and safeguards in manuscript Section 6.5; this paper performs and authorizes none.

S7.1 Pre-specified hypotheses and criteria

For each question in manuscript Section 9.1, this section proposes a hypothesis, data design, primary measure and result that would count against the specification. E2's interval settings remain deployment-specific choices, to be fixed before any data are examined. Where a question in Section 9.1 is broader, the test below addresses the part that bears on the three record requirements or, for E5, on the agent's added value. Thresholds and sample sizes are proposed defaults. E1's non-inferiority margin, E3's false-flag margin and E8's tolerable and assumed release rates are named parameters that a platform fixes and records before data collection, and E9's negligible reduction in reference error is one that it fixes before any data are examined; this section does not set them. A platform may change them before it starts, if it records the change before examining any data. No data have been collected, and whoever runs the plan can register it with a time stamp.

C1 and C2 do not need the agent: E1, E3 and E9 test them without one, and E9(a) needs only records a platform already holds.

A first study within a quarter. Before or beside E9(a), a platform can audit a random sample of closed cases for the three failures the requirements target: an absence claim resting on a query that was partial, truncated or limited in scope; a missing report read as a negative on a channel a decision had closed or whose window had not ended; and corroboration whose supporting records trace to one root observation or to an earlier conclusion. Two auditors code each case independently from the records the case cited and from what the source systems held at the time, and record whether the failure would change the conclusion. A case the records cannot settle is coded as such, and that share is itself a result. The audit reports, for each failure, the share of cases in which it occurred and the share in which it changed the conclusion, with 95 percent intervals and agreement between auditors. With 200 cases, an exact 95 percent interval on any share is at most 14.3 points wide. The audit measures how often the targeted failures occur; it does not test whether the records prevent them. It reviews identifiable staff's work on real case records, so it needs the same ethics and privacy review as E1.

Four rules apply to all nine evaluations. First, each evaluation freezes the information each method may use at an as-of cutoff and separates development from test data. Second, it states how true outcomes are decided, by whom, and blind to which method produced each finding. Its error and abstention rules are set in advance, and it states base rates. Third, where ground truth comes from labels shaped by control decisions, it says how that bias is avoided. Otherwise it reports relative performance among detected cases only. Fourth, records from tests, replays and emulations are marked when created and kept out of production labels and lessons.

Each evaluation is judged separately, without correction for multiple tests, because support in a setting requires every confirmatory evaluation to pass its complete rule. Each confirmatory evaluation targets 93 percent power: the chance of passing its complete rule under stated effect assumptions. If each reaches that target, all four pass with probability at least 72 percent by the union bound, $1-4\times0.07$, or about 75 percent if their results are independent. Sizing must account for every pass criterion and case or reviewer clustering. The minimum counts below are not power calculations; the sizing assumptions must be recorded before main-study data are collected. E1, E3, E8 and E9 are confirmatory and the rest are exploratory. Each criterion has three possible results. Support: its pass rule is met. Evidence against: a bound at the same confidence level, taken from the other side, lies on the failing side of its threshold; for example, E3 shows excess false flags if the lower one-sided 95 percent bound on the increase is at or above the margin. Inconclusive: neither holds, or the target cannot be identified from the data. A failure criterion below means only that support was not established; the interval and the identification limits decide which of the other two results applies. No result by itself shows that the underlying idea is wrong. Investigators cannot be blind to the added records, so the raters, not the investigators, are blind. A lower or upper 95 percent bound is an end of a two-sided 95 percent interval unless it is marked one-sided.

E1 (tests the second requirement; confirmatory). Hypothesis: coverage and learned-time records reduce the share of unsupported conclusions on cases with partial history or with links learned late, without reducing the correct, supported conclusions reached per case.

Data and design: closed real cases of that kind, each worked by different investigators with and without those records, and rated by two blind raters. Investigators are assigned to the two conditions at random, balanced so that each works cases in both conditions and none works the same case twice. Raters score conclusions as single propositions under a rubric fixed in advance: they split compound conclusions into their propositions and merge restatements of one proposition, so that each distinct proposition is scored once however it is phrased or grouped. A stratum of closed cases with complete history is worked and rated the same way. Who investigates is fixed

before the study starts: people, the agent, or both as separate arms, each analyzed on its own. If both arms are run, E1 fails if either arm meets a failure criterion, and the power target applies to both arms together. Conclusions reach the raters in a common format without coverage or learned-time field names. Each rater records which arm they believe produced each conclusion, so that blinding can be checked. Raters judge each conclusion against the case's complete record as of the time it was written, the same record for both arms. Agreement is reported as Cohen's kappa, and a third rater settles disagreements. A 30-case pilot, excluded from the main study, estimates the level without the records for sizing. The main study will be sized for 93 percent power for its complete pass rule, assuming the share truly falls by half and correct, supported conclusions per case do not fall. Intervals allow for several conclusions per case.

Primary measures: the share of conclusions rated unsupported by the evidence then available and, co-primary, the number of correct, supported conclusions per case, rated by the same blind raters against the closed case's resolution. Because the records can lower the share of unsupported conclusions simply by leading investigators to abstain, abstentions per case are reported for each arm and stratum.

Failure criteria: Fails if, in the cases with partial history or links learned late, the share falls by less than a third of the level without the records, or the 95 percent interval on the paired difference includes zero. It also fails if, in those cases or in the complete-history stratum, the lower 95 percent bound on the difference in correct, supported conclusions per case (with the records minus without) is at or below minus the non-inferiority margin.

E2 (tests the first requirement; exploratory). Hypothesis: the control-decision record is complete enough to estimate outcomes under other decisions (manuscript Section 7.1).

Data and design: a simulation with known effects first, then the last quarter of decisions where the platform already randomizes traffic under its own authorization. Record that quarter's start and end dates before examining the data. The target is matured reported outcomes: holdout rates count the reports received once each channel's window has closed, and report truth is reviewed on a random sample. A usable probability is one logged with the feature values and model version that produced it. The deployment chooses the intended coverage defined under the primary measures; it must be at least 95 percent.

Primary measures: the share of randomized decisions logged with a usable probability, feature values and model version. Also, the share of overlap populations whose holdout rates fall outside the predicted interval. Each interval predicts the observed outcome rate in a held-out population, including its sampling variation. Before examining any data, specify the estimator, interval construction, intended coverage and overlap populations. Intended coverage is the planned share of repeated holdout rates the intervals contain. These deployment-specific settings are not selected here.

Failure criteria: Fails if fewer than 95 percent of randomized decisions carry a usable probability, or more overlap populations fall outside their predicted intervals than the intended coverage plausibly allows: a one-sided binomial test, treating the populations as independent, gives p below 0.05.

E3 (tests report linkage, which the first requirement depends on, together with cluster monitoring; confirmatory). Hypothesis: linking each report to its transaction, and computing the network's monthly ratio for each linked cluster, flags evasion earlier than the network's ratio for each account.

Data and design: at least 30 linked-account clusters with later confirmed outcomes, channels kept apart, and at least 100 legitimate multi-brand businesses from onboarding. The pass rule is judged only on clusters selected by a confirmation route documented as independent of either monitoring rule; clusters from other routes are reported separately. Adjudicators blind to both rules' outputs fix the onset of evasion for each cluster from case evidence. Each program is applied as the network's own documentation states it, with Stripe's guide used only as a secondary summary. Time to flag is analyzed as paired, right-censored time-to-event data: a cluster that a method has not flagged by the end of follow-up is censored there for that method. A third arm computes the network's ratio for each account after linking. It separates the effect of linking from that of pooling accounts into a cluster. The cluster and third arms count only reports with verified links, such as a match on the network's transaction identifier. Flags that need reports linked otherwise, such as by card number and amount alone, are reported separately. The failing result applies to the stated contrast, and the third arm attributes any lead. Estimate the difference in false-flag probabilities using the same legitimate businesses under both rules, preserving business-level pairing and any additional clustering. Prespecify the interval method and size the study for the complete lead-time and false-flag pass rule at the 93 percent power target, given the expected share of verified report links.

Primary measures: days from the adjudicated onset of evasion to the flag, and false flags. A flag before the onset may be unrelated to the evasion, so time to flag is computed twice: counting a flag on or before the onset as day 0, and counting only flags on or after the onset. The lead time is the difference in restricted mean time to flag, account arm minus cluster arm, up to a horizon fixed before any data are examined.

Failure criteria: Fails if, under either count, the lower bound of the 95 percent interval on the lead time, estimated from the paired censored analysis, is zero or less. It also fails unless the one-sided 95 percent upper confidence bound on the increase in the probability that a legitimate multi-brand business is flagged, cluster arm minus account arm, is below the false-flag margin, proposed as 5 percentage points. An interval that crosses the margin is inconclusive about this guardrail; an observed difference below the margin alone does not establish support.

E4 (tests the first requirement; exploratory). Hypothesis: for each control change (a new rule, a threshold move or a model version), the records support a rate of harm to legitimate users with a defined denominator.

Data and design: a sample of control changes, run before E1 to E3 and E9 as a feasibility check.

Primary measure: the share of sampled changes with a computable rate and interval.

Failure criteria: Fails if fewer than 80 percent of sampled changes have one.

E5 (tests the agent's added value; exploratory). Hypothesis: the agent with human review matches or improves confirmed findings per reviewer hour compared with a person using tools. Case error rates are no more than 2 percentage points higher than either comparator arm's.

Data and design: at least 700 frozen cases and three arms: threshold rules, a person with tools, and a person with the agent. Errors are counted per case. Both human arms see the same records. In E5, reviewer time covers human investigation, tool or agent operation, checking, release and rework. Measure these activities on the same basis in both human arms. Include work on cases that produce no correct finding. A random share of cases, fixed in advance, is worked without agent access; it also supplies the independent labels that manuscript Section 4.2 requires for validating

detections. As a supplementary analysis, set the threshold-rules arm to act on as many cases as the person-with-agent arm, reporting its results by depth of prior history and for fraud bursts defined in advance.

Primary measures: correct findings, errors, abstentions, reviewer minutes per correct finding, cost and latency, and the share of labels that carry an agent-output link.

Failure criteria: Fails if, for either comparator arm, the upper 95 percent bound on the paired difference in error rates, agent arm minus that arm, is 2 percentage points or more, or reviewer minutes per correct finding are higher. At a 10 percent error rate, 700 cases worked in two independent arms would give a half-width of about 3.1 points, so the pairing must remove much of that variance, or E5 needs more cases; it is sized by simulation before it starts. For minutes, higher means that the 95 percent interval on the agent arm's ratio to the human arm lies wholly above one. Avoiding a failure criterion does not by itself establish equal error rates or improved efficiency.

E6 (tests the third requirement; exploratory). Hypothesis: the safeguards prevent attacker-influenced content from gaining unauthorized control over tool calls, outbound traffic, released claims and the evidentiary status of records.

Data and design: a red team that adapts to the defenses from the four attacker positions in manuscript Section 6.5, each with its attempts, budget and model access stated. Content is planted in every input the agent reads, and every field the agent can write is checked for it. Planted content includes attempts to make the agent omit retrieved records that count against a claim and attempts to steer it away from queries that would return such records.

Primary measures, per position: attempts that cause an unauthorized tool call, transfer or memory write; released material claims that a blind adjudicator judges false; and missing links back to agent outputs.

Failure criteria: Fails if any write to released organizational memory occurs without human release or any required link back is missing. It also fails if a false claim about a named entity is released, either clearing it or stating that activity is absent. Success for each position is reported with its budget, without a pass mark.

For these criteria, a write is one that adds or changes a released claim; monitoring, expiry and withdrawal records are status records. Against the insider position, a release or link removal by that insider is an authorized action. E6 reports whether the release record, the logged link removal, expiry and correction detect and limit it, and the failure criteria apply to releases and removals that position did not make.

E7 (tests the third requirement; exploratory). Hypothesis: re-testing, scoped release and withdrawal keep a reused lesson from degrading later investigations without delaying useful lessons.

Data and design: lessons released under varied strictness, planted poisoned lessons, and an expiry schedule disclosed to the red team.

Primary measures: the rate of degraded later investigations, the time to reuse, and the planted lessons released and still active.

Failure criteria: Fails if a planted poisoned lesson is released and still active after its expiry or re-test date. It also fails if the median time to reuse exceeds 14 days.

E8 (tests the third requirement; confirmatory). Hypothesis: reviewers and releasers catch planted wrong drafts when cited records are checked at the rate and materiality tiers planned for

deployment and they do not know which drafts are planted. Claims about named entities are checked in full, and a person releases every draft.

Data and design: planted drafts, interleaved with production drafts at realistic volume and at a stated prevalence close to the expected production error rate, spread across reviewers, with intervals that allow for clustering by reviewer. The realistic-prevalence arm must reach the required numbers of planted drafts and planted false exonerations by itself, because both failure criteria apply to it. A higher-prevalence arm may be added only for secondary estimates by error type; it does not count toward the failure criteria, and both arms are reported. In a laboratory search task, observers missed 7 percent of targets when targets appeared on half the trials and 30 percent when they appeared on 1 percent [43]. A test that plants errors often could therefore overstate how many the gate catches, so E8 plants errors at a realistic rate without telling reviewers or releasers which drafts are planted. Planted drafts concern synthetic entities or closed cases whose cited records are test-marked and whose named entities have no account action pending. They carry the test environment mark when created; reviewer-facing views hide it, while the stores enforce their exclusion from production labels, intelligence and lessons. The gateway refuses any control request or urgent-containment routing that originates from a test-marked draft, and it tells the decider that the draft is planted before any action. Released planted drafts are withdrawn after scoring. Planted errors include false exonerations, drafts that wrongly clear a named entity; omissions of retrieved records that count against a claim, including records that the checker's fixed rule marks and records it leaves to the sample (manuscript Section 6.4); and drafts whose only support for a material claim is a released item or a record linked to one. The mix of planted error types is fixed before the study starts. Some planted errors come from the agent's own earlier runs and the rest are written independently. A lower catch rate on the agent's own errors would indicate shared errors, although the two sets may also differ in difficulty. As specified, E6 does not separate errors the reviewer shares with the agent from other misses. The number of planted false exonerations is sized for 93 percent power to show a release rate below the tolerable rate, given an assumed true release rate stated in advance, and the number of planted drafts is sized so that the complete rule, with the catch-rate criterion, reaches that power. The following counts illustrate the false-exoneration endpoint under independent Bernoulli trials with a common release probability and a fixed sample size. They do not account for reviewer or case dependence or the separate catch-rate criterion; the actual study must be sized for its complete rule under the prespecified clustered design. With none released, showing a rate below 1 percent at one-sided 95 percent confidence needs at least 299, the smallest n with $0.99^n < 0.05$. If the true rate is 0.1 percent, 93 percent power to show a rate below 1 percent needs 628, the smallest such number. With 628, two or fewer releases show it, because at a true 1 percent rate that many occur with probability 4.98 percent; at 0.1 percent they occur with probability 97.4 percent. If planted false exonerations made up 5 percent of the drafts reaching review, 628 of them would take 12,560 drafts, about 628 days at the 20 drafts a day assumed in manuscript Section 6.4. The plan states the tolerable rate, the assumed rate, the prevalence and the implied duration together. One site at that volume would need about 21 months. Sites may pool planted drafts under one protocol, or use a group-sequential design that can stop once a bound is met; the choice is fixed before the study starts. A site that cannot reach the required numbers runs E8 as exploratory and reports catch rates without the pass rule.

Primary measures: the catch rate, overall and by error type (false exonerations, other wrong claims, omissions of retrieved contrary records, and support resting only on released items or records linked to them); the release rate of planted false exonerations; reviewer minutes per released draft; and how often the recorded random sample of unmarked uncited returned records contained a record that counted against the claim. For the catch rate by reviewers and the releaser, a planted error

counts as caught only if one of them identifies it, by naming the wrong claim or the missing record; a draft returned or left to expire without that finding does not count. The checker's catch rate counts planted errors that its fixed rules reject. Catch rates are reported for the checker, reviewers and releaser, for each prevalence arm, and for errors from the agent's own runs and independently written errors.

Failure criteria: Fails if the lower 95 percent bound on the catch rate by reviewers and the releaser is below 80 percent, counting planted errors that the rule checker did not reject, or the one-sided 95 percent upper bound on the release rate of planted false exonerations exceeds the tolerable rate stated in advance. Both criteria apply to the realistic-prevalence arm alone.

The release gate has a cost that E8 measures. If a system produced 20 drafts a day and a person needed 30 minutes to read each draft's cited records, review would take 10 hours a day. The gate therefore moves analyst work and may not remove it. At realistic volume the reviewer may need to read a sample of each draft's cited records, tiered by materiality. Claims about named entities are always checked in full, and a person still releases every draft.

E9 (tests the first requirement's channel states; confirmatory). Hypothesis: compared with the strongest reading available without them, channel-state and maturity records reduce the absolute error of an evaluation quantity against a mature holdout reference for the same prespecified target.

Data and design: two parts with two comparators, both recorded before any data are examined. The pass comparator is the strongest reading available without channel-state records: for each rail, one maturity period equal to that rail's standard window, with blocked attempts excluded. Comparing with this reading, not only with the platform's current rule, keeps a pass from merely reflecting a short maturity period. The platform's current label rule, with its existing maturity period and its treatment of blocked or reversed items, is the second comparator; it is reported but does not count. (a) Historical reclassification: a fixed cohort of payment attempts, payouts and account decisions, with the decision logs, disputes, early fraud warnings, returns and other reports the platform already holds. Labels are built under each comparator and under C1, which reads a missing report as a provisional negative only where its channel matured open under its original meaning. The cohort, channels and read times are recorded before any data are examined. (b) Error against a randomized holdout reference: decisions where the platform already randomizes traffic under its own authorization, as in E2. At operational read times, an evaluation quantity that the platform computes today, such as a detection's precision or a control's false-positive rate, is computed under each reading. Before any data are examined, the plan states how items that any reading leaves unlabeled enter the quantity, whether excluded, bounded or estimated under a stated delay model, and how channels without a defined reporting window enter the holdout comparison. D is also reported under each other handling: exclusion, the stated delay model, and bounding with every unlabeled item counted first as a positive and then as a negative. The quantity, its population, denominator and read times, and the method applied to unlabeled items are the same under every reading, so that the comparison tests the records, not a change of estimator. In the comparison that counts, blocked attempts are outside that population for the pass comparator, for C1 and for the reference. How the reference treats items whose channel a decision closed or changed in meaning is fixed before any data are examined and uses no reading's labels. Each reading is compared with a reference for the same quantity and target population constructed from the holdout after the longest defined reporting window has closed, with report truth reviewed on a random sample. The target is the selected metric on matured reported outcomes after that sampled truth review. Prespecify how the truth-review sample contributes to the reference and its uncertainty. Checking

reports does not reveal fraud that was never reported; a target of underlying fraud would require a separate ascertainment and identification design. Prespecify a joint uncertainty procedure for the two readings and the reference that preserves pairing, randomization, truth-review sampling and relevant clustering. Rule events that reopen a window during follow-up are recorded and reported. The main study will be sized for 93 percent power for part (b), which carries the pass rule, under stated effect assumptions.

Primary measures: (b) the reduction in absolute error against the holdout reference, with its 95 percent interval. For pass-comparator estimate q_0, C1 estimate q_1 and holdout reference r, the reduction is $D = |q_0 - r| - |q_1 - r|$; positive values favor C1. The interval includes uncertainty in both readings and in the reference under the prespecified joint procedure. Because D uses absolute values, it is not smooth where $q_1 = r$, which is where C1 succeeds. Standard delta-method and bootstrap intervals can miss their stated coverage there, and the observed $|q_1 - r|$ tends to overstate C1's error. Name the interval method before any data are examined, and show by simulation that it reaches its stated coverage where $q_1 = r$ and where $D = 0$. A paired bootstrap that resamples randomization units within truth-review strata is a candidate only if it passes that check. On the worked example below, the percentile interval from a paired bootstrap fails it where $q_1 = r$, and an interval built from two smooth parts of D passes it. Size part (b) by simulating the same method. The simulation, with known outcomes and the platform's channel windows and decision rates, also checks that D can be zero or negative under this design, so that a pass is not guaranteed by construction. D is also reported on the items where the pass comparator and C1 disagree, and against the platform's current rule. This endpoint measures agreement with that reference. Statistical bias instead concerns an expected estimate minus an identified target over a specified sampling process; this realized comparison does not estimate it. Reported but not counted as support: (a) the share of each comparator's negatives that C1 classes as closed, delayed, changed in meaning, immature or without a defined window. Items whose channel state is unknown are excluded from that share and reported separately as a coverage shortfall, with, by channel, the share of affected items whose channel state, clock start and window can be determined rather than recorded as unknown. Also reported: the reports that later arrive on each comparator's negatives, and the change in an existing control's measured error rates and in the ranking of two candidate rules.

Failure criteria: Fails if the lower 95 percent bound on the reduction in reference error is at or below the negligible reduction, a named parameter fixed before any data are examined. It also fails if D changes sign between exclusion and the stated delay model. The two bounds are reported and do not count toward the rule. Counted as negatives, the unlabeled items give both readings the same value wherever the readings differ only on those items, so D is zero by construction. Counted as positives, they overstate the quantity unless nearly all of them later draw a report. Measure (a) does not count toward passing, because the share that C1 reclassifies follows partly from its definitions and from the cohort's composition.

Worked example, with hypothetical counts: the quantity is one detection's precision on card payments: of the attempts it flagged, the share that drew a fraud chargeback. The holdout arm has 1,100 flagged attempts, and another control blocked 100 of them. The two readings and the reference therefore estimate precision on the same 1,000 completed attempts. For 760 of them the chargeback window had closed by the read time, with 200 fraud chargebacks. For 240 the window was still open on the channel's own clock, though the rail's standard period had passed since the attempt; 40 had drawn a fraud chargeback and 200 had not. The readings differ only on those 200. The pass comparator reads them as negatives, so $q_0 = 240/1000 = 0.240$. C1 leaves them unlabeled and the plan excludes unlabeled items, so $q_1 = 240/800 = 0.300$. If 40 more fraud chargebacks

arrive before the last window closes, $r = 280/1000 = 0.280$ and $D = 0.040 - 0.020 = 0.020$. If 5 arrive, $r = 245/1000 = 0.245$ and $D = 0.005 - 0.055 = -0.050$. The later reports decide the sign of D; the definitions do not. Counting the 200 as negatives instead gives $q_1 = q_0$ and $D = 0$. Counting them as positives gives $q_1 = 440/1000 = 0.440$ and, with 40 later chargebacks, $D = 0.040 - 0.160 = -0.120$. The example leaves out truth review and sampling error.

Interval check on the worked example: `tools/e9_interval_check.py` draws 10,000 samples of 1,000 attempts at the example's rates. In each sample it builds two 95 percent intervals for D from 999 resamples of the attempts (results). The first is the percentile interval. Where the reference equals C1's reading, with 60 later chargebacks expected per 1,000 attempts so that $r = q_1 = 0.300$ and $D = 0.060$, it contains D in 8,703 samples. It lies wholly below D in 1,292 and wholly above in 5, and the estimate of D averages 0.006 too low. So it misses its stated coverage where C1 succeeds, and it errs by understating C1. Where $D = 0$, with 30 later chargebacks expected so that $r = 0.270$, it contains D in 9,494 samples, and its lower bound lies above zero in 191 where the stated level allows 250. The second interval uses the smooth parts of D. When $q_1 \geq q_0$, $D = \max(\min(L, W), -W)$ with $L = 2r - q_0 - q_1$ and $W = q_1 - q_0$. It takes a 97.5 percent percentile interval for each part and reports the range of D over the two. It contains D in 9,696 samples where $r = q_1$ and in 9,765 where $D = 0$. The check assumes independent attempts and one sample size, with no truth review, strata or clustering. It tests the intervals, not the full pass rule. It shows that one method can meet the requirement above on this example; it does not replace the simulation on a platform's own design.

S8. Practitioner study (protocol fixed before the first response)

This study asks whether the records that C1 to C3 require change the conclusions practitioners draw, how often the failures they target occur, and what the field records today. It measures conclusions and reported practice, not detection performance. The protocol, the form, the scoring script and the hash of the answer key were committed before the first response.

Six to ten practitioners with at least two years in fraud or abuse investigation, or in building systems for it, from at least three organizations, complete one anonymous form of about 35 minutes. They read Traces A and B as many systems show them and answer eleven questions, then answer them again with the coverage, learned-time, attribution, decision-link and exposure records added. Eight questions test a requirement; three are controls. They then report how often each failure has changed a real conclusion, whether each record exists today and how hard it would be to add, whether the eleven signals of manuscript Table 2 are available at decision time, and, optionally, who owns each responsibility.

Each question has one error the records should prevent. The study reports, for each question, how many participants made that error without and with the records, grouped by requirement, with the controls and participants who had read Section 8 reported separately. It reports counts only, and negative results as prominently as positive ones. Part 3 follows Part 2, so a changed answer may reflect the reveal rather than the record. No added record bears on the three controls, so their counts show how often an answer changes on a second reading alone, and each requirement's counts are read beside them. No published figure or quote shows which organization lacks a record or signal.

The study has no institutional sponsor or funding. It follows ACM's policy on research involving human participants: adults only, recorded consent, minimal risk, no names, employers or confidential information, and deletion of responses at journal publication or after one year. No responses had been collected at this version.

S9. Extended comparison with prior work

Manuscript Section 2 develops the closest precedents for C1 to C3. This section places them within research on payment decisions, investigation and agent memory. The comparisons concern the cited designs and findings, not every capability their systems might support. Table S9.1 summarizes each requirement's nearest precedents and what the specification adds; the subsections give the wider context.

S9.1 Payment decisions and the outcomes they reveal

Payment engineering already connects records, investigation and protective decisions. Stripe describes similarity clustering for investigators [75]. It also describes a retraining cycle for card-testing models: labels are derived partly through manual expert review, and retrained models are evaluated on offline data and compared with the old model in blue-green tests before deployment [76]. These vendor accounts establish publicly described practices in their stated settings. They do not measure the proposed specification's effectiveness.

Outcome-aware evaluation also predates this work. Consumer credit met the same problem earlier as reject inference: a lender observes repayment only for the applicants it financed and asks

Table S9.1. The three requirements and their nearest precedents. The search was not systematic (manuscript Section 9.2).

Requirement	Nearest precedents and what they establish	What the specification adds
C1: outcomes linked to decisions	Selective-labels evaluation assumes data in which each case carries the decision taken [35]; learning from logged decisions treats the decision and its probability as required data [44]; decision provenance records the data flows around a decision [45]. In consumer credit, reject inference faces the same problem for rejected applicants; a review finds the common methods' assumptions mostly implicit and no method uniformly better [46]. Dhama's missing-data model carries, for each transaction, the authorization decision, whether fraud was reported and whether that report had arrived by training time, for one reporting channel, and models label corruption separately [33]; a second theoretical preprint by the same author bounds learning under delayed, censored, corrupted and counterfactually missing feedback, treating each as a distinct impairment [47]. Adyen evaluates payment-time interventions offline from transactions logged under the existing policy [48]; a Meta preprint proposes estimators for the false positive rate of blocking, which cannot be monitored directly once a user is blocked, and tests them on simulated blocking policies [49]; a fraud-operations preprint treats automating an action as an authorization decision because its labels are selective and delayed [50]; a decision-event schema records facts learned after a decision, such as when ground truth arrived, as linked records that reference the decision [51]; the coverage model in the C2 row also links records to decisions and distinguishes refused execution branches from late reports [52]; a 2015 talk abstract describes adding randomness to production fraud scoring so that a blocking model can be evaluated, and new models trained, although blocked transactions' outcomes are not observed [53].	Several outcome channels per decision, each with its own clock-start event and reporting window; a record of what each decision closed, delayed or changed in each channel, and a status for each channel at each read time; outcome reports as separate appended records with typed links to every decision that may have shaped them; separate fields for delay, unobservability and report truth, so the evaluation states joint assumptions; the recorded policy probability, inputs and case assignment that those assumptions need (manuscript Section 7.1). A platform that already joins decision logs to dispute records can use C1 to specify what the join must preserve.

Table S9.1 (continued).

Requirement	Nearest precedents and what they establish	What the specification adds
C2: query coverage and learned time	Temporal databases separate valid time from transaction time [54]; completeness of a query answer can be derived from statements about which parts of the data are complete [55]; the Dataflow model assumes a system processing unbounded data never knows whether all data have arrived, treats watermarks as heuristic estimates of progress, and revises results when late data arrive [56]. Bitemporal agent memories keep both times [57–59], and Quipu gates writes to a knowledge graph while retaining validity and recording times, with some policies requiring human approval bound to the submitted evidence [60]. A preprint audit of sixteen deployed agent frameworks reports none that writes a run record a reader can check without trusting the writer; a language model scored the audit grid, and agreement with human coders fell below the registered threshold. It proposes a log kept outside the agent's harness [61]. A coverage model separates event time from verifier receipt time and judges whether a verifier's evidence was complete at a stated cutoff; it also separates absence from one retrieval from absence in a verifier view whose closure, including retrieval coverage and retention, is justified, and specifies that basis without designing its implementation [52].	The gateway outside the agent attaches a coverage record to every result: the entities and interval requested and evaluated, the as-of cutoff, each source's event and ingestion watermarks and known gaps, the retention horizon, limits reached, access filtering, sampling and schema versions. Fixed rules outside the agent derive whether a result is complete, partial, truncated, denied or unavailable, and a scope-limited flag confines absence claims to the authorized scope (manuscript Section 6.2). Every fact, including a derived record, keeps event time and the time it first became available to queries (S4.1).
C3: human release and dependence	Truth-maintenance systems record each belief's justifications and retract conclusions whose support changes [62, 63]; STIX keeps observed data apart from intelligence assertions and opinions [64], and US intelligence analytic standards ask analytic products to distinguish underlying information from assumptions and judgments [65]. Anamnesis starts model-derived claims as candidates, and no memory operation can raise their authority without a separately recorded grant; the grantor need not be a human [59]. GovMem groups dependent agent traces when estimating support instead of counting them as independent votes, permits automatic promotion and routes unresolved candidates to human review [66]. A data-governance preprint admits only verified records as precedent, without saying who authorizes promotion or what a precedent may establish (S9.4) [67]. Albarrak and Jagtap place human approval before intelligence is shared, but do not state that analyses kept in their institutional-memory store pass that gate [68]. MAP-Graph writes memories without human release (S9.3) [69]; Li and coauthors check an authorization state that need not come from a person [70]. A formal study distinguishes independent observations from reports derived from shared evidence and requires a dependence model as well as ancestry [71]; a threat-detection design drops its own compiled detections at ingest (S9.4) [72]; an engineering assurance design binds evidence to the exact artifact, and its governing profile can require human authority [73]. AgenticCyOps provides analyst oversight without a human release decision for every item before organizational reuse [74]. TOKI's optional external callback, which may be a human, only chooses between contradicting facts [57].	The recorded grant is specialized to a human principal for every conclusion entering organizational memory, and released items stay context: a released conclusion is never counted as a new or independent observation, and a claim about current conduct must cite observations of that conduct from the current period, not scores or control decisions alone (manuscript Sections 4.2 and 6.4). Labels, assessments, control decisions, detections and threat-knowledge items carry a link to every agent output and every released organizational-memory item open in the writer's case or session. The labeling, assessment, control, detection and threat-knowledge interfaces, not the person, write these links automatically, so they also cover records a person writes with an agent output open in the case. Linked records count as dependent; a missing link does not establish independence (manuscript Section 4.2). Responsibilities 21 and 22, quality review and human release, are inherited from threat-intelligence work (S4).

whether, and under what assumptions, the outcomes of rejected applicants can be inferred. A review of common reject-inference methods finds their assumptions mostly implicit. Without financing applicants who would otherwise be rejected, the methods cannot be compared by standard model selection, and no method is uniformly better [46]. Payment practitioners have described estimating outcomes under decisions that were not taken (Table S9.1) [48, 49, 53]; Adyen's evaluation targets authorization rates, not fraud. A payment-processing patent application describes adding a treatment result, such as the outcome of an authentication step, to the feedback on a transaction, labeling transactions canceled after the treatment as canceled, and notes that fraud can be reported up to 100 days later [77]. These approaches motivate retaining the decision and the conditions under which its outcome became observable. They do not make an unreported outcome known.

Two recent proposals in Table S9.1 connect evaluation evidence to operational authority [50, 51]; Solozobov's schema also seals each decision record and types the links between decisions. C1 applies that linkage to several outcome channels. Its contribution is this payment-investigation record contract, not a new estimator of missing outcomes.

S9.2 Intelligence production and investigation

STIX is a structured language for representing and exchanging cyber threat intelligence [64]. Such representations make analysis reusable. STIX already separates observed data from intelligence assertions and opinions, but it does not address how opinions should be interpreted [64]. C3 supplies a rule for what a reused conclusion can establish in this specification. A threat-intelligence reference model supplies analysis, quality-control and feedback functions for intelligence products, and traces who created and modified each product [78]. Threat-intelligence lifecycle research likewise lets an entity that receives intelligence enrich it as a new version or retract it [79].

ExCyTIn-Bench evaluates agents on multi-step questions over security logs [80]. This benchmark establishes relevant investigative tasks and a way to evaluate particular capabilities. This specification adds requirements for interpreting the inputs to such tasks and preserving the status of their outputs across payment products.

SR-Fraud's reported comparisons (manuscript Section 2.4). With one of the three language models it reports, its point estimates also exceed those of static and periodically retrained CatBoost classifiers; with the other two, some fall below the periodically retrained classifier. For that model, against the periodically retrained classifier at that classifier's 5 percent operating point, its recall and dollar-weighted recall gains are significant, but when both block the same number of transactions none of the differences is significant. Its point-estimate gains grow with users' prior history. On the 64 percent of transactions with any prior history, its recall, F1 and dollar-weighted recall gains are significant at that classifier's 5 percent operating point, where SR-Fraud blocks 6.08 percent of all transactions; matched results are not reported by history. At the matched block count, its recall in the week-8 fraud burst is about 24 percentage points higher, without an interval [81].

PROVSEEK is close to the requirement that a claim remain checkable. Its agent cites audit-event identifiers for claims and reports searched-for artifacts it did not find [82]. C2 also requires a gateway outside the agent to record query coverage. A missing artifact then has a recorded search scope, not just the agent's account of what it searched.

S9.3 Permission to act and authority to reuse

Recent proposals bind authority to particular artifacts or actions. MAP-Graph represents memories, claims and actions in a provenance graph and records each action-gate decision with its supporting memories; the gate can return an AskUser decision for some high-risk actions [69]. Li and colleagues relate an execution attempt and its artifact to a downstream-use authorization state, checked at publication [70]. Agile-V binds evidence to an exact artifact and links effects to authorization records; its governing profile can require human authority [73]. AgenticCyOps provides analyst oversight and an audited memory-write path, without specifying human release for every reused item [74]. A threat-intelligence architecture requires human approval before operational action or dissemination, but does not state that analyses kept in its institutional-memory store pass that gate [68]. These are concrete precedents for authorization records. C3 makes a narrower, stronger choice for organizational memory: a person releases every conclusion, and the released conclusion remains context or hypothesis.

Vendor architectures draw related lines. One keeps an append-only event record, a maintained fact record and a decision record that binds selected evidence and facts to policy, approval, action and outcome, with human or automated approval [83]. Another states that agent-generated summaries are not treated as authoritative business records [84]. Neither defines outcome channels, query coverage or a release rule for reusing conclusions.

A survey of persistent agents calls for records tying actions to the state that justified them [85]. EDDOps links versioned evaluation records to the agent changes they prompt [86]. Both motivate preserving the connection between an output and its later effects, which C3's links back to agent outputs and released items keep (Table S9.1). Human release does not erase this dependence or turn the output into independent evidence.

Financial-sector and audit guidance (manuscript Section 2.4). An AI risk-management handbook from Project MindForge, an industry initiative led by the Monetary Authority of Singapore, treats traceability of individual agent decisions as part of explainability, suggests searchable logging, stresses human review for certain risky actions, names injection into shared agent memory as a threat and describes agentic governance as nascent. It also notes that real-time human oversight may not be feasible for fraud detection engines [87]; C3's release gates entry into memory, not each real-time decision. A white paper on runtime safeguards for agentic finance proposes a check before a consequential agent action or output is executed or relied on, and an append-only audit log of every governance decision. Where feasible, the agent's account of its steps should be checked against system-generated records of its tool calls and data access; a gateway variant wraps an agent's outbound calls without changing its code. In its investigation example, agents investigate flagged transactions and propose whether to file a suspicious transaction report. Controls for each alert type set mandatory steps and the minimum evidence for each conclusion, and dispositions with missing steps or insufficient evidence are denied and returned to the queue. Filing needs a compliance officer's approval, while low-risk cases with complete evidence close as false flags, subject to quality-assurance sampling [88]. Guidelines from India's computer emergency response team for auditing AI systems require auditors to identify evidence they could not access and assess its effect on coverage; lack of access is not automatically evidence of conformity. When auditors use their own AI tools, the tools' analysis is a working aid, not by itself evidence that a control works; a competent auditor must validate all AI-assisted findings, and original evidence must be kept separate from AI-derived material. Organizations must periodically assess whether human review is effective, including reviewer agreement and inappropriate automatic acceptance of AI outputs

[89]. These provisions partly parallel C2 (independent records of tool calls and data access), C3 (AI analysis is not by itself evidence) and E8 (measuring whether review works).

S9.4 Memory, dependence and revision

Agents can learn reusable lessons from experience. ExpeL extracts lessons, which it calls insights, from its successes and failures on training tasks, adds them to the prompt for later tasks and retrieves similar successful trajectories as examples [90]. This capability explains the value of reuse, but reuse can propagate an earlier mistake. A-MemGuard checks memory-derived reasoning during use, consulting lessons from stored failures [91]. Manuscript Section 7 proposes testing new lessons against counterexamples before reuse, then testing their effects in E7. This proposed control has no measured payment-platform benefit here.

The choice of memory structure depends on purpose. An investigative system needs to know whether a retrieved item is an observation or a conclusion. Studies of memory consolidation show that it can erase a claim's source; external source records restore much of the lost control in their test settings [92, 93]. Those settings used synthetic customer-service histories and benchmark attacks, not payment investigations.

Belief-revision work on threat intelligence asks that intelligence state its source and its chain of modifications [94]. A recent agent-memory design keeps an immutable raw log beneath its summaries and links each summary to the raw pages that support it [95]. SSGM separates an append-only observation log from derived memory and checks updates against protected facts [96]. A shared-memory service records writers, derivation links and supersession; its authors evaluate it without a baseline [97]. PROV-AGENT extends provenance records to prompts, responses and decisions, linking them to downstream outcomes [98]. These precedents support typed records and traceable revision. C3 does not claim to invent them.

Source ancestry is necessary but not sufficient to establish independent support. The formal study in Table S9.1 [71] shows that no rule that sees only report content can, in general, tell replication from independent corroboration. In its experiments, with one small language model reading synthetic documents, repeated extractions from one document had correlated errors (estimated correlation 0.72, in an exploratory analysis), and a deduplication method that clustered reports by text similarity tracked how they were worded far more than their ancestry. C3 follows the same concern: several agents repeating one report do not create several independent observations. Records therefore carry their roots, their producer and links to the agent outputs that informed them, and a record without a producer, or without inputs unless it is a source observation, adds no root (manuscript Section 6.4). The specification does not estimate how strong the dependence is; quality review judges that from these records. A released conclusion can guide the next query, but evidence for that conclusion must remain traceable to the underlying records.

Two recent designs bear directly on C3. A data-governance preprint commits no agent-proposed metadata decision before a steward reviews it. It proposes a promotion gate that admits only verified records as precedent, records each promotion and lets a reviewer demote a record, flagging the decisions that relied on it. It does not say who authorizes promotion or what a retrieved precedent may establish [67]. A threat-detection design tags every detection compiled from one of its hypotheses and drops tagged observations at ingest, so its own conclusions cannot re-enter as fresh evidence. It leaves as a residual risk an analyst who writes such an alert into a report that is later ingested, and its reference implementation does not yet exercise the rule [72]. C3 keeps released conclusions as context, not evidence, and its interface-written links cover records a person writes with an agent output open in the case.

S9.5 Time and coverage

Timing matters when it changes which information a decision could use. Dataflow addresses out-of-order streams, where the system cannot assume that all events have arrived [56]. Leakage research identifies information about a target that should not legitimately be available to a model [99]. C2 uses these concerns to distinguish when a fact held from when it became queryable. A relationship learned tomorrow cannot support a decision frozen today merely because the relationship existed yesterday.

Recent designs combine timing with governance: Quipu and Wu's coverage model (Table S9.1) [52, 60]. C2 applies these ideas to a query contract that records scope, coverage and availability outside the investigating agent.

Together, these precedents explain why C1 to C3 are a synthesis. The proposed contribution is their joint application to payment-platform investigation, with explicit channels, record classes, query responses and release rules. The hypothetical traces expose conclusions that fail when specified context is removed. E1 to E9 test parts of that context, including whether the channel states reduce error against a mature holdout reference, compared with the strongest reading available without them (E9) and, through planted drafts that rest only on released items, the rule that a released conclusion adds no independent corroboration (E8; manuscript Section 8.3). In S7.1, E5 and E8 measure reviewer time, and no test measures the cost of collecting the records (manuscript Section 9.1). Neither the comparison nor the traces establish that the integrated system works in deployment.

S9.6 Further limits of the evidence

The specification has not been implemented or evaluated on platform data. Its traces demonstrate reasoning over hypothetical records, while safeguards, costs on platform data and investigator workload remain unmeasured. C1's channel fields were derived from, and checked against, Stripe's descriptions of card-network rules (manuscript Section 7.1). The networks' own rules were not read; the one network document cited is Visa's overview of its acquirer monitoring program (manuscript Section 8.5). Bank debits, instant push payments and stablecoin payments, which are also in the product scope, were reviewed less fully (S4.1).

A second search on 28 and 29 October 2026 started from the paper's problem statement and the three requirement statements, without the related-work section, and logged 388 searches and page reads across patents, payment and fraud vendors, agent-governance and security-investigation products, standards and regulators, code repositories, journals and recent preprints. It found no source stating the three requirements together; the two sources it added, a data-governance preprint and a threat-detection design, are discussed in manuscript Section 2.3.

Visibility also depends on where an agent runs. SIG-34, SIG-35, SIG-39 and SIG-40 require access inside the agent, its tool server or its outbound-traffic controls. A platform can obtain that for its own agent but normally sees only interface activity from buyer- or merchant-operated agents. These signals cannot be assumed available in every deployment.

The product scope comes from Stripe's public product catalog, roadmap and documentation, including roadmap items in public preview. Other platforms may combine products differently or face other mechanisms. Public interfaces expose only part of a provider's records, so "none identified" in Table S3.1 refers only to the pinned schemas and the terms searched. Collection ownership, retention and budgets remain deployment decisions.

The focused search and author-assigned mappings do not establish exhaustive coverage or the absence of equivalent systems. Bank case-management systems, card-network risk systems, vendor architectures and non-English literature were not reviewed as complete families. Stripe's public hiring priorities influenced selection and set most of the deeper reviews (manuscript Section 3; S2).

S10. Two FTC complaints replayed on synthetic records

Question. Do the outcome records of S4.2 make the patterns alleged in two complaints measurable? The complaints are FTC v. First Data Merchant Services LLC and Chi W. Ko, No. 1:20-cv-03867 (S.D.N.Y.), ECF 1, and FTC v. AlliedWallet, Inc. et al., No. 2:19-cv-04355 (C.D. Cal.), ECF 24 [14, 16]. Complaint content is allegation, the data are synthetic and the parameters are assumptions, so the percentages describe constructed cases, not detection rates. Both complaints also allege that the processor saw evidence and did not act; records cannot fix that.

Method. `tools/replays/ftc_first_data_replay.py` and `tools/replays/allied_wallet_replay.py` generate synthetic payments, reports, decisions, attributions and links as S4.2 records, check them with the conformance rules, and compare what different views of the records flag over 1,000 runs. Results are in first_data_results.json and allied_wallet_results.json; the sweeps below are separate. Standard library only; Python 3.12 or later.

Assumptions. Monitoring rules are illustrative or the complaints' own descriptions, not any network's current rules. First Data: 30-day periods; a flag needs at least 100 reports and 1.5 percent of captures; a 120-day dispute window with reports spread across it. Allied Wallet: chargebacks of at least 100 a month and 1 percent of sales transactions; fraud reports of at least $75,000 a month or 1 percent of sales dollars; three accounts of 185 payments a month each, linked by one payout beneficiary; a 3.14 percent fraud-report rate, the mean of the four monthly ratios the complaint gives. Volumes, ticket sizes, delays and fees are assumptions.

Findings.

Alleged pattern	Without the record	With the record
Transactions spread across eight related accounts (First Data)	The account view never flags them: about 14 expected reports each against a floor of 100	A view over shared-attribute links flags the group in 91.6 percent of runs. It also flags 40 merchants assumed legitimate that share a call center in 76.7 percent
A new account after a closure (First Data)	About 97 late reports a run arrive on the closed account and face no ratio test	With a successor link, the linked unit is flagged at once in 99.8 percent of runs, and in 99.1 percent for a clean successor: those first flags are the closed account's reports. A period later the two separate (96.9 against 0.1 percent)
A switched statement descriptor (First Data)	A store that overwrites the descriptor shows the account view and, in 53.7 percent of runs, flags the new descriptor before the switch	Per-payment descriptors rebuild the monitored unit; 95.7 reports a run reach a unit with no denominator and are reported separately

Alleged pattern	Without the record	With the record
Reports linked only by card number and amount (First Data)	Counting every link flags a clean account near the floor in 7.8 to 37.0 percent of runs as unverified links rise from 10 to 50 percent	Counting only verified links gives no wrong flag and leaves the account inconclusive in 40.0 to 100 percent of runs
A merchant below the chargeback floor (Allied Wallet)	The chargeback rule never flags an account or the group: no account exceeds 24 chargebacks in a month	The fraud-report rule by value flags each account in at least 99.8 percent of runs. It needs the separate channel and each report's amount
Refunds before disputes (Allied Wallet)	A chargeback-only store reads the refunded fifth of reported payments as unreported	The fraud report is kept as its own record
Traffic moved after closures (Allied Wallet)	On average 13.5 fraud reports a run arrive on closed accounts in months with no sales, which the account view cannot test	The payout-linked group counts them against the receiving account's sales

Holds by construction. The eight accounts sit below the floor and the alleged fraud ratio is three times the threshold, so those flags follow from the parameters; only their timing depends on the assumed delays. The 40 legitimate merchants' report rate is set at 1.6 percent, above the 1.5 percent threshold, so their flag also follows from the parameters. The First Data figures divide by the previous period's captures; with the same period's, the two linked-account figures are 86.0 and 73.7 percent. The refunded share is set to 20 percent. Displacement follows from the model, which moves each closed account's volume to the remaining account. Verified links are correct by assumption.

Sweeps (manuscript Figure 3). `tools/replays/sweeps.py` varies one parameter at a time with the replays' generating processes and rules, 500 runs a point, and seeds separate from the runs above (results). First Data uses the previous period's captures. For eight related accounts at 4 percent, the account view flags in 5.4 percent of runs at 2,000 captures each a period and 98.8 percent at 2,500; the linked view flags in 27.6 percent at 300, 89.4 percent at 350 and 99.8 percent at 400. At the base values the sweep's 89.4 percent compares with 91.6 in the 1,000 runs above. At 350 captures each, the linked view flags the eight accounts in 2.2 percent of runs at a 3 percent report rate, 33.2 percent at 3.5 and 89.4 percent at 4. It flags the 40 legitimate merchants, at 300 each, in 0.6 percent at 1.25, 35.0 percent at 1.5 and 98.4 percent at 1.75. For one Allied Wallet account at 3.14 percent, the chargeback rule flags in 2.6 percent of runs at 3,000 payments a month and 96.2 percent at 4,000. The fraud-report rule flags in at least 98.8 percent at every volume from 25 to 8,000. At an assumed legitimate 0.3 percent, the fraud-report rule flags in 38.8 to 54.4 percent of runs from 25 to 185 payments a month, 17.2 percent at 500, 2.8 percent at 1,000 and none from 2,000. The swept account is steady for eight months; the replay's three linked accounts are not. A First Data group whose report rate equals the threshold flags only by chance: reports arrive over up to four periods while the accounts are active for four, so a period's expected monitored ratio is 55 to 97 percent of the report rate.

Limits of the records. Padding sales with self-funded purchases is arithmetic, not simulated: with the assumed fees, holding the chargeback ratio under 1 percent with $1 purchases costs 0.2 percent of sales, and padded payments look like clean payments with no reports. Only payment-ledger data, such as the funding instrument, can expose them. Rewriting 12,000 attributions in

place passes every rule, so the store must prevent edits. Accounts with no recorded shared attribute, shell companies and dummy websites leave nothing for an outcome record to test.

Conformance. The generated records, 144,574 for First Data and 4,240 for Allied Wallet, pass the schema and rules. A refund recorded as also closing the fraud-report channel fails OR-08, and a shared-attribute link marked verified fails OR-14.

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